

FUTURE BUSINESS ANALYST SEASON 6
ROUND 2 BUSINESS ANALYTICS REPORT

From accounts to assets

A balance-first growth strategy for DNSE Securities and the Vietnamese customers who should fund it

Selected organisation: DNSE Securities Joint Stock Company (HOSE: DSE)

Category: wealthtech and technology-enabled financial institution

Prepared for the senior management team of DNSE

Team: [Team name]

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Executive summary

DNSE Securities is one of Vietnam's most effective acquirers of investors. It opened 518,514 accounts in 2025, 19 per cent of all accounts opened in the country, held 12.7 per cent of Vietnam's securities accounts at the end of the year and handled a quarter of derivatives brokerage in the second quarter of 2026. Zero-fee trading on the Entrade X app, no branch network and fast technology made this possible.

The money has not followed the accounts. At 30 June 2026 DNSE held 2.3 to 3.5 per cent of the cash that investors keep at brokers, 1.4 to 1.8 per cent of margin lending and 0.6 to 0.8 per cent of the industry's quarterly pre-tax profit; each range runs from a press tally of all brokers to the sum of 42 filed statements. Only 5.7 per cent of accounts used any DNSE product in December 2025, and customer assets per account fell 9.5 per cent in 2025 while all three exchange indices rose. The gap is specific to DNSE. VPS, which has no parent bank, lends five times as much per account, and TCBS, which is also zero-fee and online, lends twelve times as much, with about a third of its customers trading each month.

The income statement shows the cost. Operating revenue rose 3.2 times between 2022 and 2025, while pre-tax profit excluding proprietary trading stayed between VND 128 and 221 billion a year. In the first half of 2026 each extra VND 100 of core revenue came with VND 102 of extra cost. The filings show where it went: 52 per cent to funding, 42 per cent to direct brokerage cost and only 6 per cent to administration, which includes staff and technology. Brokerage has cost more than it earned for 16 consecutive quarters, and DNSE's brokerage loss in the first half of 2026 was the largest among 42 brokers. DNSE's cost of funds is in line with bank-owned peers. What is unusual is that 38 per cent of its assets sit in term deposits and bonds, 93 per cent of them pledged to banks, that earn about what they cost, while margin lending, its widest margin, uses 116 per cent of equity against a 200 per cent ceiling. The constraint is customer money, not capital or technology.

Two causes are measured. DNSE's idle-cash account pays a typical customer 2.1 to 2.3 per cent, against 6.0 per cent at TCBS for the same balance from VND 5 million, and derivatives build market share without building balances at the broker. Two more are hypotheses for Round 3: reward-driven sign-ups, which dominate the most-endorsed complaints, and targets that reward acquisition rather than balances. Conditions raise the stakes. Deposit rates rose about 2.5 points in 2026, cash at brokers fell by more than a third in three quarters, and bank-owned brokers supplied more than half of the industry's lending growth in the second quarter.

The priority problem is therefore the balance gap: accounts that are opened but never funded with meaningful savings. It ranks first of seven candidate problems on scale, urgency, strategic relevance, strength of evidence and DNSE's control. Reaching the 2026 profit plan from lending would need a loan book 2.3 times the current one.

The recommended direction is Payday Portfolio, a salary-linked savings-to-investing layer for salaried adults of roughly 22 to 40, starting with working customers already in DNSE's base. It moves money on payday through ZaloPay and bank open interfaces, pays a market-linked yield through a partner bank or money market fund, ladders savings into bond funds, Trúng Vàng bonds and VN30 exchange-traded funds, and allows opt-in use of the portfolio as margin collateral. A trust layer removes the closure fee, pays rewards on funding rather than sign-up and reports the product to the regulator before launch. In the base case 150,000 savers would build VND 4.7 trillion of balances within 18

months, 2.4 times DNSE's investor cash today. Three quick wins run alongside: repricing the idle-cash account, reviewing the per-trade costs DNSE absorbs and reactivating dormant accounts.

Round 3 should test seven assumptions before commitment, led by the distribution of balances by cohort, customers' response to the cash yield, the legal structure of the cash layer and enrolment in a 20,000-customer payday pilot.

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1. Introduction

1.1 DNSE and its business model

DNSE Securities began in 2007 as Dai Nam Securities and became a technology-led broker after Encapital acquired it in 2020 (CafeF, 2024c). Listed on HOSE since July 2024, it had total assets of VND 15.2 trillion and equity of VND 5.4 trillion at 30 June 2026 (DNSE, 2026a; Table A1). It sells only through the Entrade X app and website and offers lifetime zero-fee trading in listed shares (CafeF, 2024b). Revenue therefore comes from interest on margin loans, managed deal by deal through Margin Deal, derivatives brokerage, interest on term deposits and bonds held to maturity, and proprietary trading. Each depends on customers keeping money on the platform.

1.2 Market context

Vietnam had 11.9 million securities accounts at the end of 2025, against 7.3 million two years earlier, and individuals supply more than 90 per cent of trading value (Vietnam Securities Depository and Clearing Corporation [VSDC], 2026; Dân trí, 2026b). With TCBS, MBS, Pinetree and DNSE all offering zero-fee trading, commissions no longer separate brokers (CafeF, 2024b). Profit comes from lending, which earned securities firms VND 12.2 trillion in the second quarter of 2026 against VND 3.7 trillion from brokerage (Vietstock, 2026h).

1.3 Business area and question

This report asks how DNSE can turn a large account base into funded customer relationships, and which savers it should target first. It asks where between sign-up and profit value is lost, measured against the market and named peers, why it is lost, and which response creates most value within DNSE's capabilities, funding and regulatory limits. Investment banking, proprietary trading strategy and new ventures are out of scope.

2. Findings of observations

2.1 Evidence base and approach

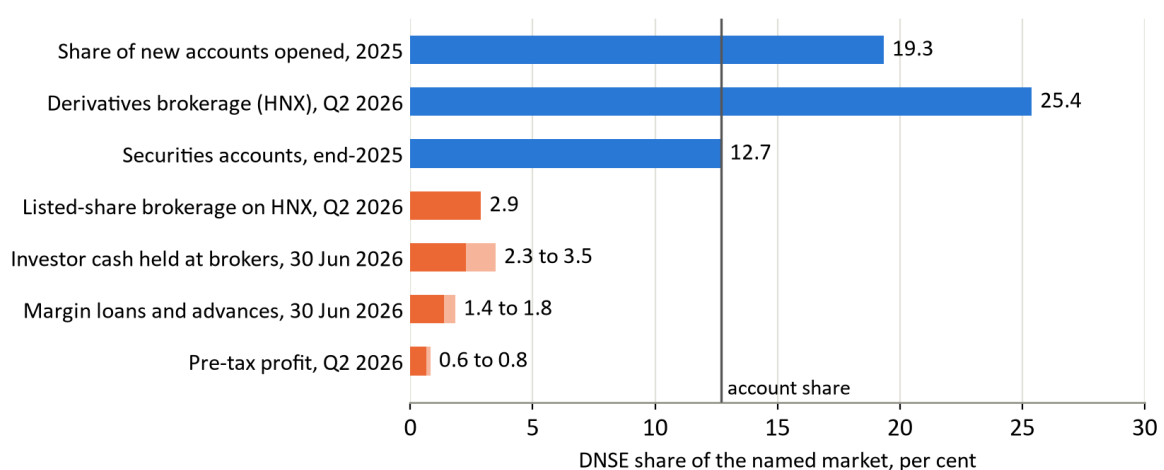
The analysis combines eight datasets (Table A2). Its core is 395 line items of DNSE's filed statements from 2018 to mid-2026, pulled from Vietcap's data service and reconciled to the half-year statements reviewed by KPMG, with the same template for 41 other brokers. Market shares come from the original HOSE and HNX announcements, account totals from VSDC and customer indicators from DNSE's 2025 annual report. One cleaning rule set, applied equally to VPS and FPTs, removed loan advertising and referral farming from 867 DNSE Google Play reviews, leaving 670 (Table E1). Every share uses a denominator of the same date and definition; where a press tally and the sum of filed statements give different industry totals, both are reported. Hypotheses are labelled as such and reappear in the validation plan. The main limitation is the absence of customer-level data, so demographics and funnel stages are inferred (Table G3).

2.2 Finding 1. DNSE wins accounts but not money

DNSE is one of Vietnam's most effective acquirers of customers. It opened 518,514 accounts in 2025, 19 per cent of the 2.68 million opened in the market, and held 12.7 per cent of all securities accounts at the end of the year (DNSE, 2026d; VSDC, 2026). Its share of derivatives brokerage rose from 4.0 per cent in the first quarter of 2024 to 25.4 per cent in the second quarter of 2026, second only to VPS (Hanoi Stock Exchange, 2026; Figure A1).

The picture reverses when money replaces registration as the measure (Figure 1). In the second quarter of 2026 DNSE handled 2.9 per cent of listed-share brokerage on HNX and stayed outside the HOSE top ten. At 30 June 2026 it held 2.3 to 3.5 per cent of investor cash at brokers, 1.4 to 1.8 per cent of margin lending and 0.6 to 0.8 per cent of quarterly industry pre-tax profit. An average DNSE account therefore holds 0.18 to 0.27 times the cash, and borrows 0.11 to 0.14 times the loans, of an average account in the market (Figure A2).

Figure 1. DNSE's share of each market against its share of accounts



Source: VSDC (2026); DNSE (2026d); HNX; filings via Vietcap Securities (2026); press tallies (Table D1). Light bars span the two industry totals.

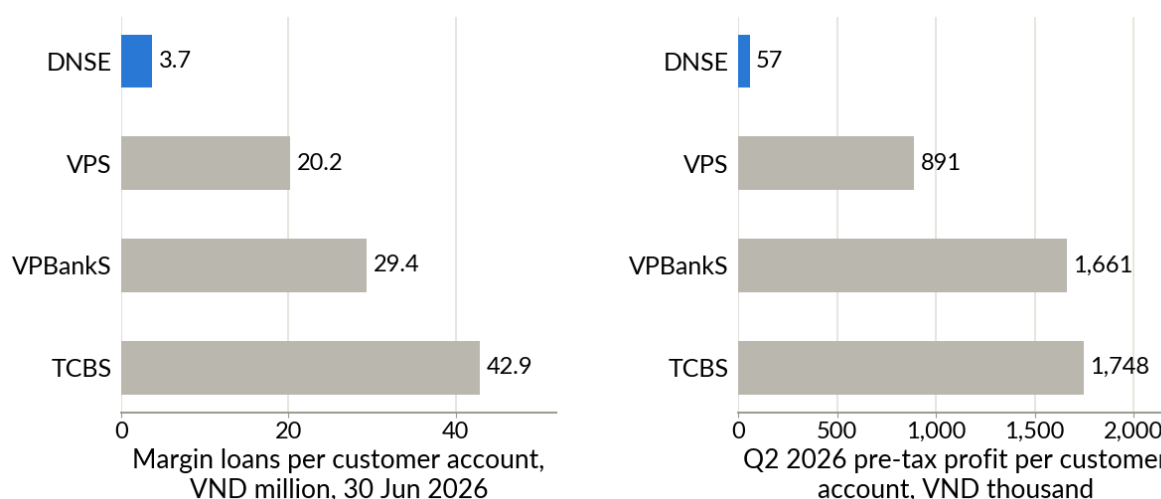
The gap widens as the base grows. Margin lending per account fell from VND 4.4 million at the end of 2023 to VND 3.7 million in June 2026, and cash per account fell to VND 1.15 million (Figure A3).

Customer assets per account fell 9.5 per cent in 2025, to VND 35.3 million, in a year when the VN-Index rose 41 per cent, the UPCoM index 28 per cent and the HNX-Index 9 per cent (DNSE, 2026d). Only 85,739 customers, 5.7 per cent of accounts, used any DNSE product in December 2025, twice as many as a year earlier but still a very low base.

2.3 Finding 2. The gap is specific to DNSE

Three objections could explain the gap away: that every broker counts dormant accounts, that app-based zero-fee brokers attract only small savers, or that DNSE lacks a parent bank. Peers with similar account bases answer all three (Figure 2; Table A3). VPS, a retail broker without a parent bank, lends VND 20.2 million per account, more than five times DNSE's VND 3.7 million. TCBS, also zero-fee with 99 per cent of accounts opened online, lends VND 42.9 million per account, and about 34 per cent of its customers traded on its app in December 2025, against 5.7 per cent of DNSE accounts using any product (TCBS, 2026c; Table D2). Second-quarter pre-tax profit per account was VND 57,000 at DNSE and VND 0.9 to 1.7 million at VPS, VPBankS and TCBS. Account counts differ in date, but not enough to close gaps of this size.

Figure 2. Lending and profit per customer account, DNSE against VPS, VPBankS and TCBS



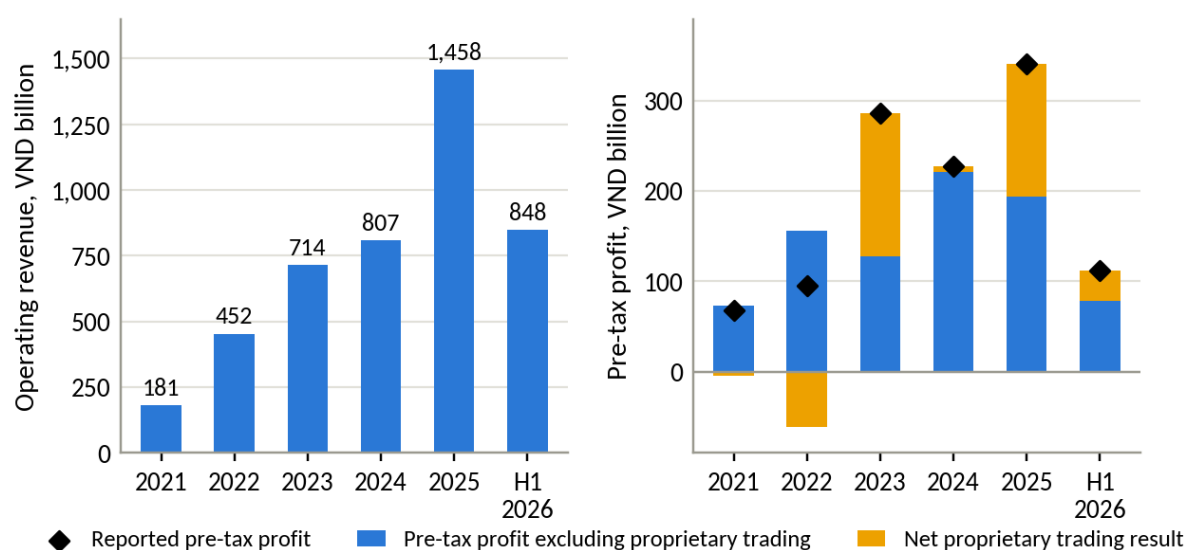
Source: filings for 30 June 2026 via Vietcap Securities (2026); company releases for account counts (Table A3).

Customer reviews place the problem at the start of the relationship. Since March 2023, 5.6 per cent of DNSE's cleaned Google Play reviews concern sign-up bonuses or rewards, against 0.7 per cent for VPS and none for FPT. The most-endorsed complaints, from June 2025, say that a VND 100,000 sign-up reward required a VND 2 million deposit and that closing an account cost VND 100,000 (Figure A5; Table E5). Deception, bonus terms and closure appear in 24 per cent of negative reviews but attract 43 per cent of their helpful votes (Figure A4). Crashes and login failures are more common but do not set DNSE apart, since its Google Play rating is above those of VPS and FPT.

2.4 Finding 3. Revenue grows while core profit stands still

Operating revenue rose 3.2 times, from VND 452 billion in 2022 to VND 1,458 billion in 2025 (Figure A6). Pre-tax profit excluding proprietary trading stayed between VND 128 and 221 billion a year (Figure 3). The two years of strong reported growth, 2023 and 2025, rested on trading gains of VND 158 and 146 billion.

Figure 3. Operating revenue and pre-tax profit split into core business and proprietary trading



Source: DNSE filings via Vietcap Securities (2026); authors' calculations. H1 2026 is not annualised.

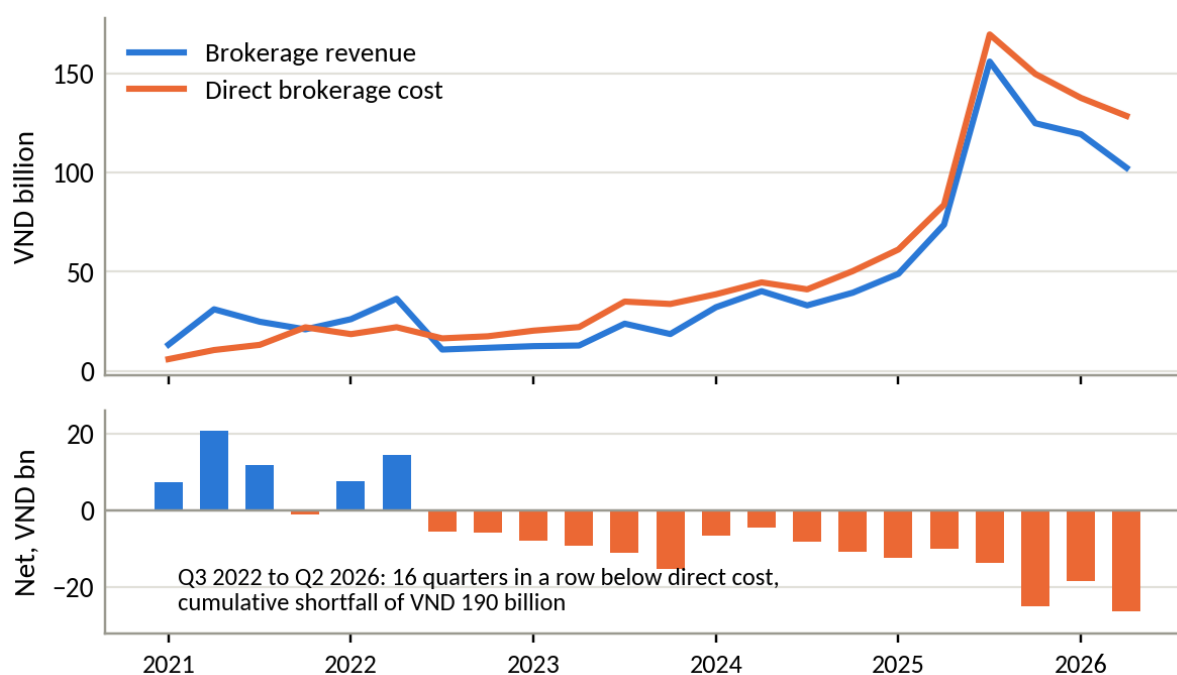
In the first half of 2026 core revenue rose by VND 285 billion on a year earlier and core costs by VND 289 billion, so each extra VND 100 of core revenue brought about VND 102 of extra cost; including trading losses, pre-tax profit fell 29 per cent (Figure A7). By mid-year DNSE had delivered 20 per cent of its 2026 pre-tax profit target of VND 550 billion (Vietstock, 2026b), and its annualised return on equity of 3.8 per cent was below the 6.8 per cent paid on a 12-month deposit at a state-owned bank (VietnamNet, 2026).

2.5 Finding 4. Brokerage and funding absorb the growth

The filings show where the extra cost went (Table A4). Of the VND 289 billion rise in core costs in the first half of 2026, funding took 52 per cent, direct brokerage cost 42 per cent and administration, which includes staff, outsourced services and technology, 6 per cent. Comparing 2025 with 2024 gives the same picture: brokerage 52, funding 40 and administration 5 per cent. Technology spending is not what absorbs revenue growth; fixed assets, including leased equipment, are 1 per cent of total assets.

Brokerage is the first source. Its direct cost has exceeded brokerage revenue in each of the 16 quarters since the third quarter of 2022, with a cumulative shortfall of VND 190 billion (Figure 4). The cost moves with revenue, which covered 78 to 92 per cent of it in each of the last eight quarters, so it behaves as a per-trade cost, not a fixed investment. In the first half of 2026 DNSE lost VND 44.5 billion on brokerage after direct costs, the largest loss among 42 brokers with filed statements and 2.6 times the next, while the industry earned VND 1.5 trillion (Table A5). The notes do not split this cost, but DNSE pays exchange fees on free share trades and has paid derivatives margin fees for customers since May 2025 (Vietstock, 2025b).

Figure 4. Brokerage revenue against direct brokerage cost, by quarter



Source: DNSE filings via Vietcap Securities (2026); authors' calculations.

Funding is the second source. Average borrowings rose 43 per cent and the estimated cost of funds rose from 4.6 to 6.3 per cent between the first halves of 2025 and 2026 (Figure A8). The rate itself is normal: on the same method TCBS paid 7.8 per cent in the second quarter of 2026, VPBankS and MBS 6.8 per cent and VPS, which has no parent bank, 5.1 per cent, against DNSE's 6.5 per cent (Table A6).

2.6 Finding 5. Capital is not the constraint

Margin loans were 116 per cent of DNSE's equity at 30 June 2026 against a regulatory ceiling of 200 per cent, leaving room for about VND 4.6 trillion of additional lending, and shareholders added VND 1.3 trillion in March 2026 (CafeF, 2026a). Lending is the widest margin: an 11.2 per cent yield in the first half of 2026 left a spread of about 4.9 points over the cost of funds, so each extra VND 1 trillion lent adds about VND 49 billion of pre-tax profit a year before credit losses. What limits lending is demand from customers with money.

Meanwhile 38 per cent of total assets sits in term deposits and bonds held to maturity, against 1 to 22 per cent at eight large peers (Table A6), and 93 per cent of these assets were pledged to banks for DNSE's borrowing at 30 June 2026 (DNSE, 2026a, note 8(b)). They yielded about 6.0 per cent in the first half of 2026, close to the cost of the funds behind them (Figure A8), so they supply 23 per cent of revenue and almost no profit (Figure A9).

3. Discussion and main analysis

3.1 Why the money does not stay

A five-whys analysis links the symptom to DNSE's own design (Tables B1 and B2). Two causes are measured. The first is the price of the cash product: DNSE's idle-cash account pays a fixed 1.8 per cent, and 2.1 to 2.3 per cent to a customer with less than VND 500 million (DNSE, 2026b), while TCBS's iPower pays 6.0 per cent on the same balance from VND 5 million and banks' automatic-earning accounts paid 3.5 to 4.3 per cent in 2025 (TCBS, 2026a; DNSE, 2025; Figure B1). A saver has no financial reason to keep money at DNSE. The second is the product mix. Derivatives give DNSE its largest market share, but investors post margin at the clearing house, so the franchise builds activity, and brokerage losses, without building balances.

Two further causes are hypotheses for Round 3: reward-driven intake, which would explain accounts that receive only the deposit a reward requires, and targets built on accounts, market share and order speed rather than balances, which would explain why no competitive savings product exists.

Four alternative explanations were tested. The market cycle does not explain 2025, when every index rose and assets per account fell, and in 2026 DNSE's investor cash fell 38 per cent, in line with the industry (Figure B2). Capital is not the constraint, and the peer comparison controls for dormant accounts. The fourth, that DNSE acquires young customers now to monetise them later, cannot be rejected with public data, because new cohorts dilute per-account averages and active users doubled in 2025; cohort data, the first test in Section 4.4, would settle it.

3.2 Market and customer context

Conditions in 2026 raise the cost of the gap. Credit grew faster than deposits in 2025, banks raised 12-month deposit rates by about 2.5 points in 2026, and household deposits reached a record of more than VND 11 quadrillion in June (FiinRatings, 2026; VietnamNet, 2026; Vietstock, 2026i; Table B3). Cash at brokers fell by more than a third in three quarters (VnEconomy, 2026b), and bank-owned brokers supplied more than half of the growth in margin lending in the second quarter (Vietstock, 2026g). The pool is large: one tenth of one per cent of household deposits equals 5.6 times DNSE's investor cash (Table B4), and no independent digital broker yet offers salaried savers a competitive place for a monthly surplus (Table B5).

Index data show that 37 per cent of Vietnamese adults receive wages into an account, with the largest formally saved surplus among working adults in the upper income groups (World Bank, 2025b; Appendix F). Young adults save into an account every month as often as older adults, but only 8 per cent save for old age, against 23 per cent of adults aged 25 and over. In a 2025 survey, 81 per cent of investors wanted professional advice and a third feared non-transparent fees (Nhân Dân, 2025; VnEconomy, 2025).

3.3 Lessons from comparable firms abroad

Zero-fee brokers abroad met the same problem earlier and solved it by gathering assets (Table B6). Robinhood's growth after 2021 came from net deposits, USD 68 billion in 2025, helped by retirement accounts and a higher cash yield (Robinhood Markets, 2026), and Trade Republic passed the central bank rate to customers and automated savings plans, reaching more than EUR 150 billion of assets

(Trade Republic, 2025). Vietnamese securities firms cannot take deposits, so DNSE must gather balances through partners (Table B7).

3.4 Target market, priority problem and problem statement

Five candidate markets were scored on six weighted criteria (Table B8). Salaried mass-affluent adults rank first under both weighted and equal scores: they hold the formally saved surplus, earn monthly income and are partly in DNSE's base already. Young first-time investors remain DNSE's strongest franchise but its weakest source of balances, so the scope is salaried customers of roughly 22 to 40, including Gen Z customers once they start work, in their first 90 days on the platform (Table B9).

Seven candidate problems were compared on scale, urgency, strategic relevance, data support and control (Table B10). The balance gap ranks first under both weightings; the trust deficit ranks second and becomes a condition within the solution, and loss-making brokerage, reliance on trading gains and funding cost are partly its symptoms. Reaching the 2026 profit plan from lending at the current spread would need a loan book 2.3 times today's, backed by about 2.5 times the customer assets DNSE held at the end of 2025 (Figure B3).

Problem statement. DNSE opens nearly one in five of Vietnam's new securities accounts but holds 2.3 to 3.5 per cent of investor cash and 1.4 to 1.8 per cent of margin lending. It converts sign-ups into funded, retained relationships at a low rate, above all in the first 90 days, because its incentives reward opening accounts and its products give salaried customers no competitive, trusted reason to keep money on the platform. As a result, core profit has not grown since 2022 while revenue tripled (Table B11).

3.5 Strategic alternatives

Six responses were scored on six weighted criteria (Table B12), and Payday Portfolio, a salary-linked savings-to-investing layer, ranks first. Continuing acquisition-led growth adds accounts from the segment with the least money. A derivatives-to-shares bridge waits for same-day trading, possibly until 2028 (Người Quan sát, 2026), and deepens exposure to the activity penalised in August 2026. An advisory tier needs advisers DNSE deliberately avoided, a bank or e-wallet alliance works better as a channel than as a strategy, and reintroducing fees would break the zero-fee promise. Three quick wins should run alongside: repricing the idle-cash account, reviewing the per-trade costs DNSE absorbs and reactivating dormant accounts.

4. Recommendations

4.1 The preliminary recommendation

DNSE should build Payday Portfolio, a savings tab in Entrade X, separate from the trading screens, that turns a customer's monthly surplus into a growing balance (Figure B4). It targets salaried adults of roughly 22 to 40, starting with DNSE's own low-balance accounts held by working customers, and acts in the first 90 days and on each payday after them.

Salary link. On payday a fixed amount chosen by the customer moves from a bank account or ZaloPay wallet to DNSE, through ZaloPay, a partner since 2023, or a standing order today, and through the open banking interfaces banks must support by March 2027 (Thanh Niên, 2023; State Bank of Vietnam, 2024).

Cash layer. Money earns a market-linked return through a sweep into a partner bank deposit or a licensed money market fund. The partner pays the yield and DNSE earns a distribution fee, so DNSE takes no deposits, and the yield does not depend on trading.

Ladder. Goal rules split the balance between bond funds, the existing Trứng Vàng bonds from VND 1 million and VN30 exchange-traded funds, each shown with a realistic range of returns.

Optional collateral. After a suitability check, part of the portfolio may back Margin Deal loans at conservative ratios; leverage is never the default.

Trust layer. The closure fee is removed, rewards are paid only on money that stays, terms, uptime and onboarding success are published, onboarding moves to the VNeID platform, and the product is reported to the State Securities Commission before launch, once the control gaps found by the August 2026 penalty are closed (Market Times, 2026). Tables B13 and B14 set out the journey and the evidence.

4.2 Value logic and expected outcomes

Value comes in four ways, in order of certainty: retaining money that is already leaving, distribution fees on balances, lending against balances at a 4.9-point spread, and cheaper growth, since the first wave comes from accounts DNSE has already paid to acquire. In the base case, 150,000 savers, about one in eleven accounts, contribute VND 2.5 million a month and keep 70 per cent on the platform. After 18 months the layer would hold VND 4.7 trillion, 2.4 times DNSE's investor cash today, and earn about VND 72 billion a year (Table B15; Figure B5). It rebuilds the balance base for 2027 and 2028 but will not rescue the 2026 plan.

4.3 Feasibility and risks

The building blocks already exist (Table B16). Four risks matter most. On price, a competitive yield could cost more than it earns; a 3-point bonus paid by DNSE on all existing investor cash would cost about VND 59 billion a year, so any bonus applies to new contributions only. On regulation, a structure deemed deposit-taking would be refused, so sweep and fund routes are preferred. On conduct, collateral use is opt-in and capped. On execution, a savings product that fails on payday would destroy trust, so reliability targets are a launch condition.

4.4 Validation direction

Seven assumptions must be tested before commitment (Table B17), led by the distribution of balances by cohort, customers' response to the cash yield in a randomised test, the legal structure of the cash layer and a 20,000-customer payday pilot, which should reach 25 per cent enrolment within 60 days with 70 per cent of contributions kept at 90 days. The legal structure is settled first and gates the pilot (Figure B6). The main success measure is the funded-account rate, the share of accounts holding at least VND 5 million for 30 consecutive days.

5. Conclusion

DNSE has solved the hardest problem for a new broker, getting noticed: it opens nearly one in five new accounts in Vietnam and handles a quarter of derivatives brokerage. It has not solved the problem that decides profit, getting customers to keep money with it. Its accounts hold a fraction of the market's cash and loans, its core profit has not grown since 2022, and each extra unit of revenue now brings as much extra cost, mostly per-trade brokerage cost and funding. The constraint is the product and its incentives, which Payday Portfolio changes. Round 3 should begin by measuring how many of DNSE's accounts are funded today.

Appendices

Appendix A. Exhibits for the findings

Appendix A holds the figures and tables behind Section 2, in the order in which the text cites them.

Table A1. DNSE at a glance

Item	Detail
Legal name and listing	DNSE Securities Joint Stock Company, HOSE code DSE, listed 1 July 2024
Scale	Charter capital VND 4,282.5 billion; total assets VND 15,208 billion; equity VND 5,440 billion
Ownership	Encapital group and its chairman about 49.7 per cent; Capella Group 9.8 per cent (March 2026)
Customers	More than 1.7 million accounts (mid-2026); 518,514 accounts opened in 2025; 85,739 active users in December 2025
Distribution	Entrade X app and web only; no branches; account opening by electronic identity check; ZaloPay partnership since 2023
Pricing	Zero fees on cash equity trades without borrowing; 0.045 to 0.085 per cent on Margin Deal trades; derivatives margin deposit, withdrawal and management fees paid by DNSE since May 2025
Products	Entrade X (shares), Future X (derivatives), Margin Deal (deal-by-deal lending), Tài khoản không ngủ (idle-cash account paying 1.8 to 4.3 per cent), Trứng Vàng (bonds from VND 1 million), Ensa (artificial intelligence assistant), Lightspeed API (algorithmic trading)
Market position, Q2 2026	Second in derivatives brokerage (25.38 per cent); eighth in listed-share brokerage on HNX (2.88 per cent); outside the HOSE top ten (below 2.94 per cent)
2026 plan	Revenue VND 1,736 billion; pre-tax profit VND 550 billion; VND 3,500 billion bond programme; securities subsidiary at the International Financial Centre
Regulatory record	Fined VND 802.5 million on 17 August 2026 and ordered to stop three derivatives financing services offered without prior notice to the State Securities Commission

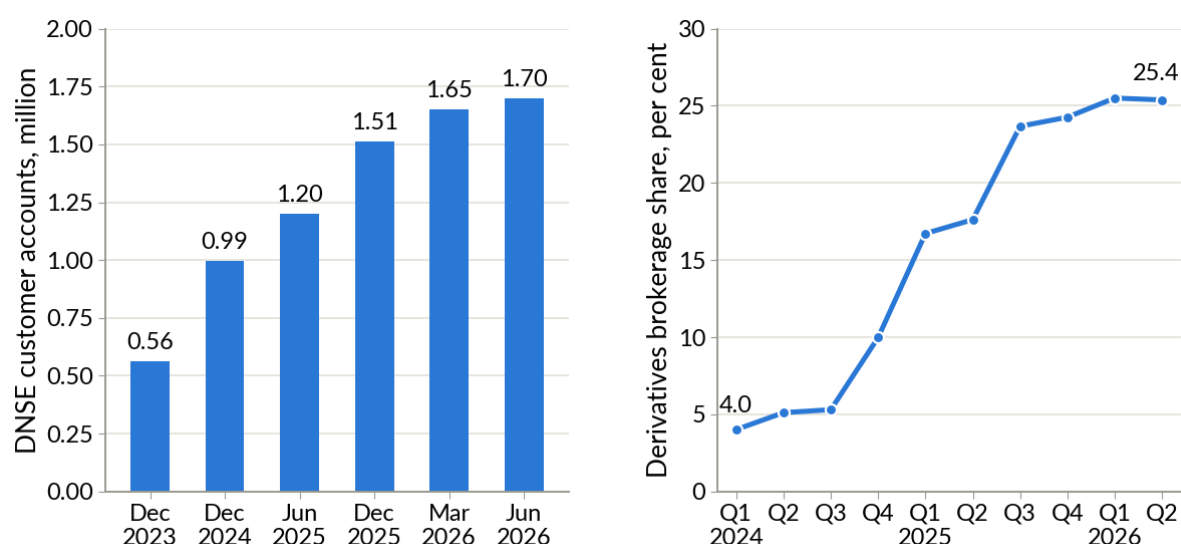
Source: DNSE filings retrieved from Vietcap's data service; DNSE investor relations and product pages; DNSE (2026d); Vietstock (2026a, 2026b, 2026f); CafeF (2026c); Kinh tế Chứng khoán (2026) for ownership; Market Times (2026). Figures at 30 June 2026 unless stated.

Table A2. Evidence base

Dataset	Content and coverage	Main preparation step
DNSE filed statements	395 line items of the income statement, balance sheet, cash flow and notes, first quarter of 2018 to second quarter of 2026	Pulled line by line from Vietcap's data service and reconciled to the half-year statements reviewed by KPMG
DNSE company indicators	Accounts, new-account shares, active users, customer assets, derivatives share, 2026 plan, product terms and fee schedules	Taken from investor relations releases and product pages; each figure dated and cross-checked with a second report where possible
Exchange and industry data	HOSE and HNX brokerage shares; industry margin lending, investor cash at brokers and pre-tax profit; trading value; account statistics	Each share kept with its own exchange; competing industry totals recorded and one chosen per measure
Named peers	VPBankS and TCBS accounts, lending, profit and customer cash	Filed statements through Vietcap for lending and profit; company releases and the financial press for account counts, whose dates differ and are stated
Google Play reviews	867 DNSE reviews (October 2020 to September 2026) and 1,377 reviews of VPS SmartOne and FPTs EzTrade	Collected on 23 September 2026 and cleaned with one rule set for all three apps
App Store reviews	1,055 written reviews of the same three apps and Apple's star-rating counts	Collected on 24 September 2026; used as a cross-check for 2025 and 2026
World Bank Global Index	51 indicators for Vietnam across 13 demographic segments (2024 fieldwork) and five survey waves from 2011	Retrieved from the World Bank open data interface; segment population shares recovered from the survey itself
Macro, banking and international	GDP, inflation, credit, deposits and rates (NSO, SBV, bank rate sheets); reference reports listed by the organisers; annual results of Robinhood, Futu and Indian and Japanese market data	Dated at source; forecasts and projections labelled as such

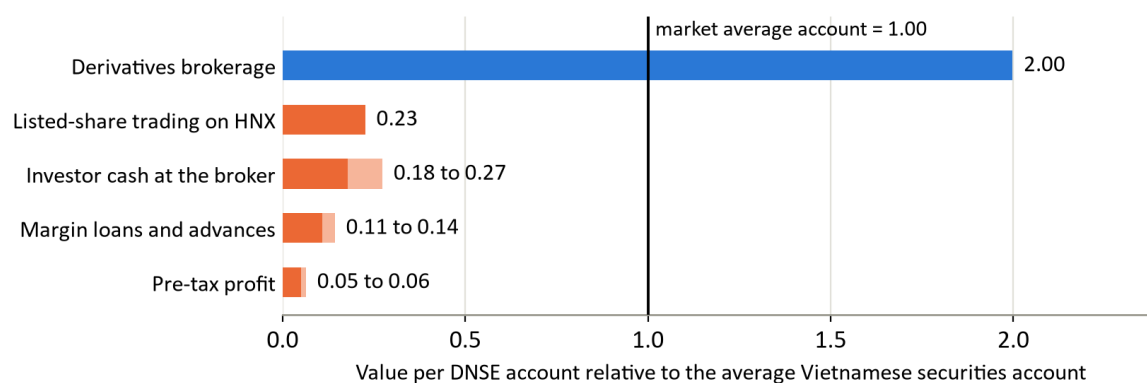
Source: compiled by the authors. Access dates between 20 and 27 September 2026. Full addresses in Appendix H.

Figure A1. DNSE customer accounts and derivatives brokerage share



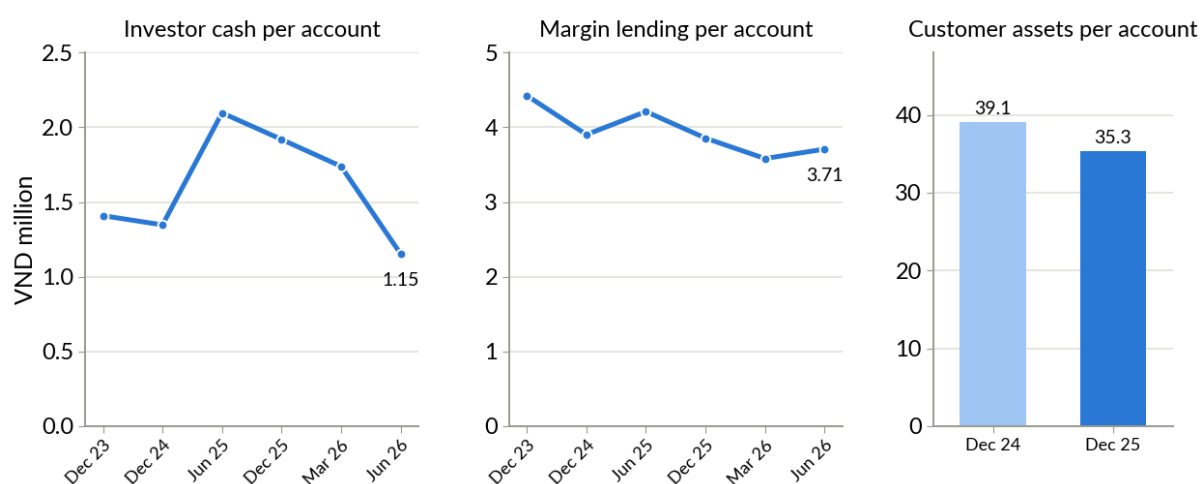
Source: DNSE's 2025 annual report (DNSE, 2026d) for year-end accounts; VnExpress (2025) and Vietstock (2026c) for June 2025 and March 2026; DNSE releases for mid-2026; Hanoi Stock Exchange (2026) for derivatives brokerage shares since DNSE entered the top ten in the first quarter of 2024.

Figure A2. Value of an average DNSE account relative to the average Vietnamese securities account



Source: as for Figure 1. Each value is DNSE's share of a market divided by its share of securities accounts, 12.7 per cent (1,512,920 of 11,871,933 accounts at the end of 2025; 12.66 per cent at 30 June 2026). Light bars span the two industry totals in Table D1.

Figure A3. DNSE investor cash, margin lending and customer assets per account



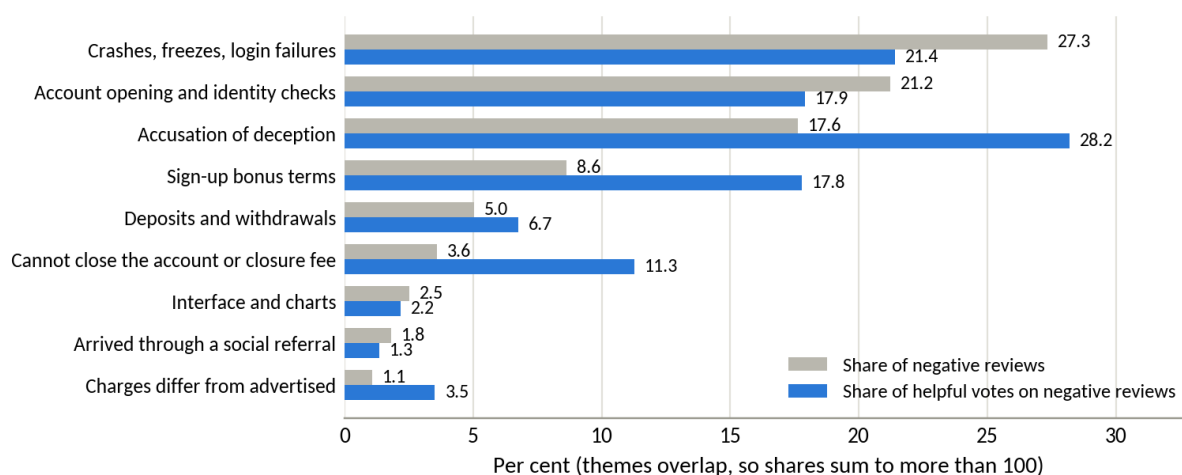
Source: DNSE filings (off-balance-sheet investor cash, loans); DNSE releases (accounts, customer assets); authors' calculations. Account counts for December 2023, 2024 and 2025 are from DNSE's 2025 annual report.

Table A3. DNSE against three named peers with similar account bases

Indicator	DNSE	VPBankS	TCBS	VPS
Customer accounts, million	1.70	1.30	1.20	1.55
Margin lending, 30 June 2026, VND billion	6,303	38,200	51,500	31,300
Lending per account, VND million	3.7	29.4	42.9	20.2
Pre-tax profit, Q2 2026, VND billion	97.4	2,159	2,097	1,378
Profit growth, Q2 2026 on Q2 2025	+7%	about 4 times	+21%	+57%
Pre-tax profit per account, Q2 2026, VND thousand	57	1,661	1,748	891
HOSE brokerage share, Q2 2026	below 2.94%	3.57%	9.36%	12.61%
Investor cash per account, VND million	1.15	1.1	5.5	9.3
Parent bank	none	VPBank	Techcombank	none

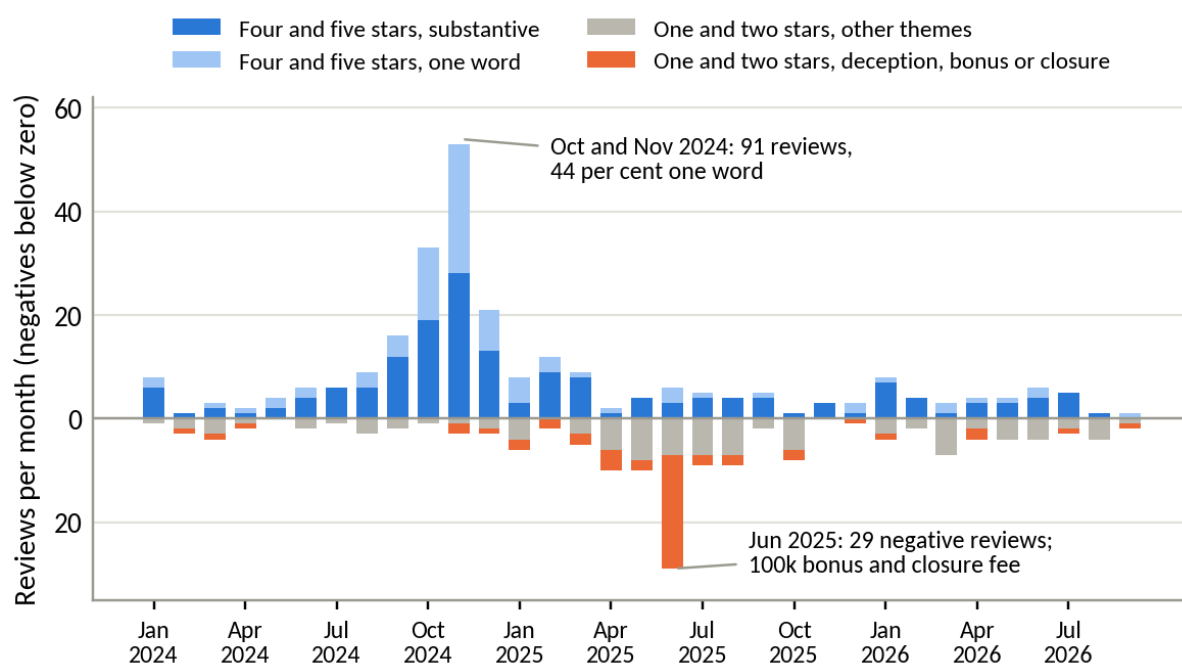
Source: each firm's filed statements for the second quarter of 2026, retrieved through Vietcap Securities (2026), for lending, profit and investor cash; company releases for accounts (Vietstock, 2026d; TCBS, 2026c; VPS Securities, 2025); HOSE quarterly announcement for brokerage share; authors' calculations. Account figures are dated May 2026 (VPBankS), end-2025 (TCBS), September 2025 (VPS, from its IPO presentation) and mid-2026 (DNSE). VPS figures are filed under the ticker VCK. Per-account values are averages, which large clients raise at every firm. Investor cash is the off-balance-sheet cash each firm reports; bank-linked account models keep part of customers' cash at the parent bank, so this row is the least comparable.

Figure A4. Themes in DNSE's negative reviews, by count and by helpful votes



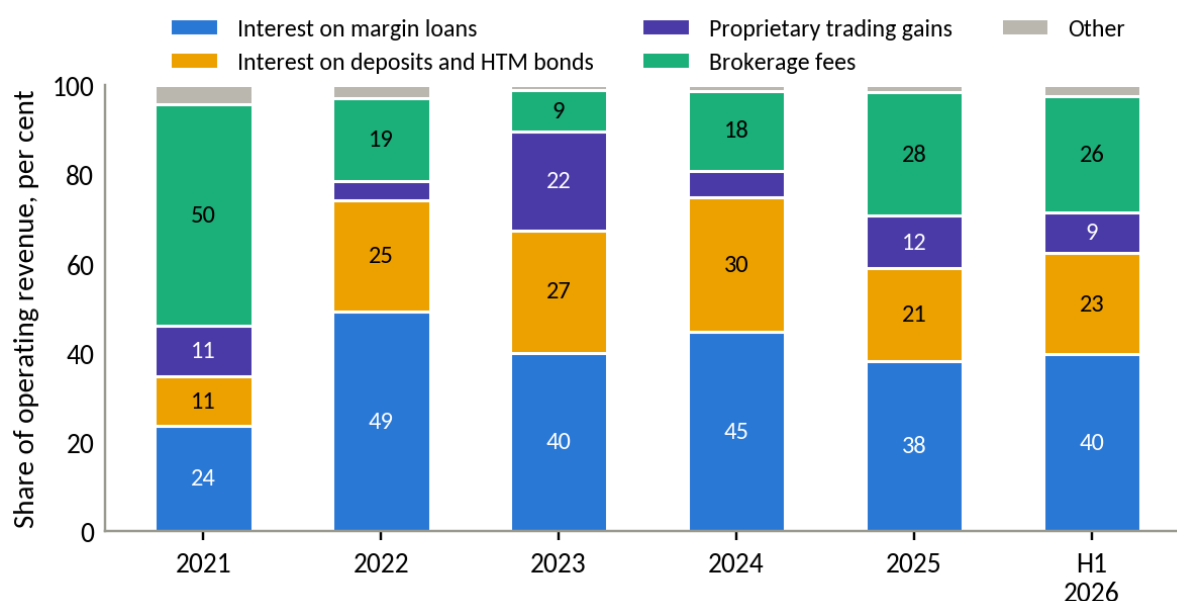
Source: Google Play, retrieved 23 September 2026; authors' cleaning and coding. 278 negative reviews carrying 1,794 helpful votes.

Figure A5. DNSE reviews per month, positive above the axis and negative below



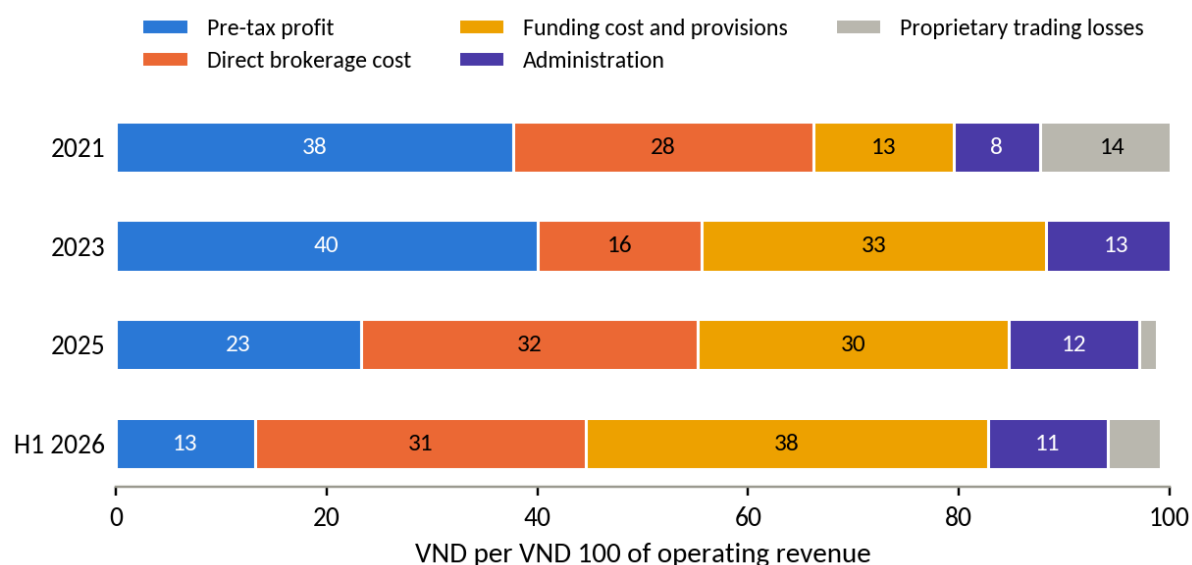
Source: Google Play, retrieved 23 September 2026; authors' cleaning and coding.

Figure A6. Composition of DNSE operating revenue



Source: DNSE filings, authors' calculations.

Figure A7. Where each VND 100 of operating revenue goes



Source: DNSE filings, authors' calculations. Funding cost and provisions combine interest expense and template line 24.

Table A4. Where DNSE's extra revenue and cost came from (VND billion)

Item	H1 2025	H1 2026	Change	2024	2025	Change
Core operating revenue	486.3	771.0	+284.7	759.5	1,286.5	+527.0
of which interest on margin loans and advances	228.8	336.1	+107.3	360.5	555.8	+195.2
of which interest on deposits and bonds held to maturity	128.1	193.4	+65.3	245.0	303.9	+58.9
of which brokerage revenue	122.8	222.1	+99.2	144.8	404.0	+259.2
Core costs	403.9	693.3	+289.3	538.8	1,092.5	+553.6
of which funding cost (interest expense and template line 24)	172.3	324.1	+151.9 (52%)	210.6	429.8	+219.2 (40%)

Item	H1 2025	H1 2026	Change	2024	2025	Change
of which direct brokerage cost	145.1	266.5	+121.4 (42%)	174.8	464.9	+290.0 (52%)
of which administration (staff, outsourced services, depreciation)	78.7	95.4	+16.7 (6%)	151.9	181.4	+29.5 (5%)
of which other operating items (residual)	7.9	7.2	-0.7	1.5	16.4	+14.9
Core pre-tax profit	82.4	77.7	-4.6	220.7	194.0	-26.7
Net proprietary result	75.1	33.9	-41.3	6.8	146.2	+139.4
Reported pre-tax profit	157.5	111.6	-45.9	227.5	340.2	+112.7
Extra core cost per VND 100 of extra core revenue			102			105

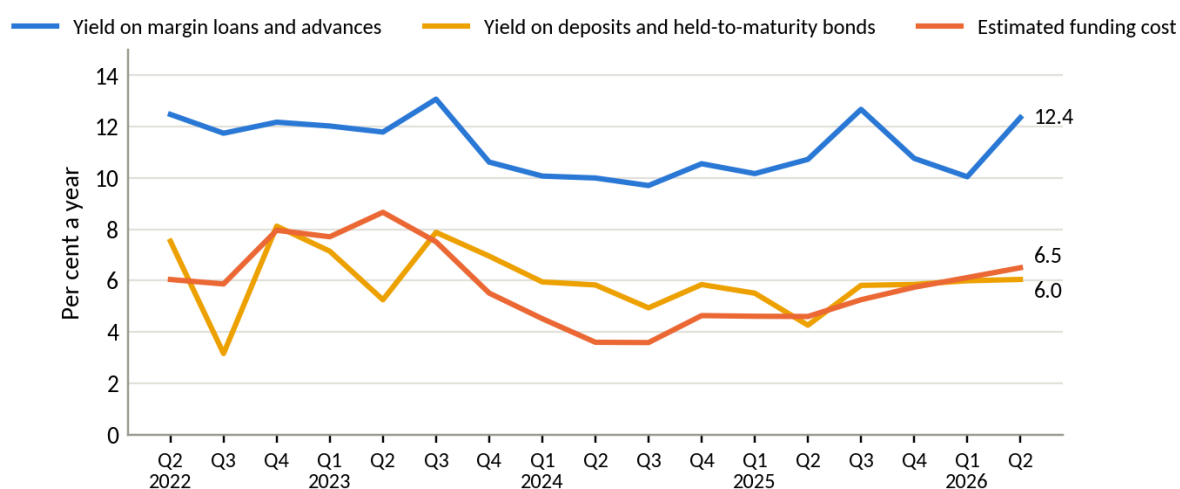
Source: DNSE filed statements via Vietcap Securities (2026); authors' calculations. Core excludes gains and losses on financial assets at fair value through profit or loss. Template line 24 combines loan-loss provisions with the borrowing cost of the loan book; the allowance for loan losses rose by only VND 9 to 11 billion in each half-year, so the line is mostly funding cost. Percentages are shares of the change in core costs.

Table A5. Brokerage revenue against direct brokerage cost, first half of 2026: DNSE and the largest brokers (VND billion)

Broker	Brokerage revenue	Direct brokerage cost	Result after direct cost	Revenue as % of direct cost
VPS	1,637.0	1,415.1	+221.9	116
SSI	1,068.5	706.2	+362.2	151
Vietcap	565.5	349.1	+216.4	162
HSC	521.0	401.7	+119.2	130
TCBS	493.3	210.2	+283.1	235
MBS	405.0	349.4	+55.6	116
VNDirect	381.7	267.3	+114.4	143
VPBankS	260.4	257.7	+2.7	101
DNSE	222.1	266.5	-44.5	83
All 42 brokers with filed statements	7,032.2	5,568.8	+1,463.4	126

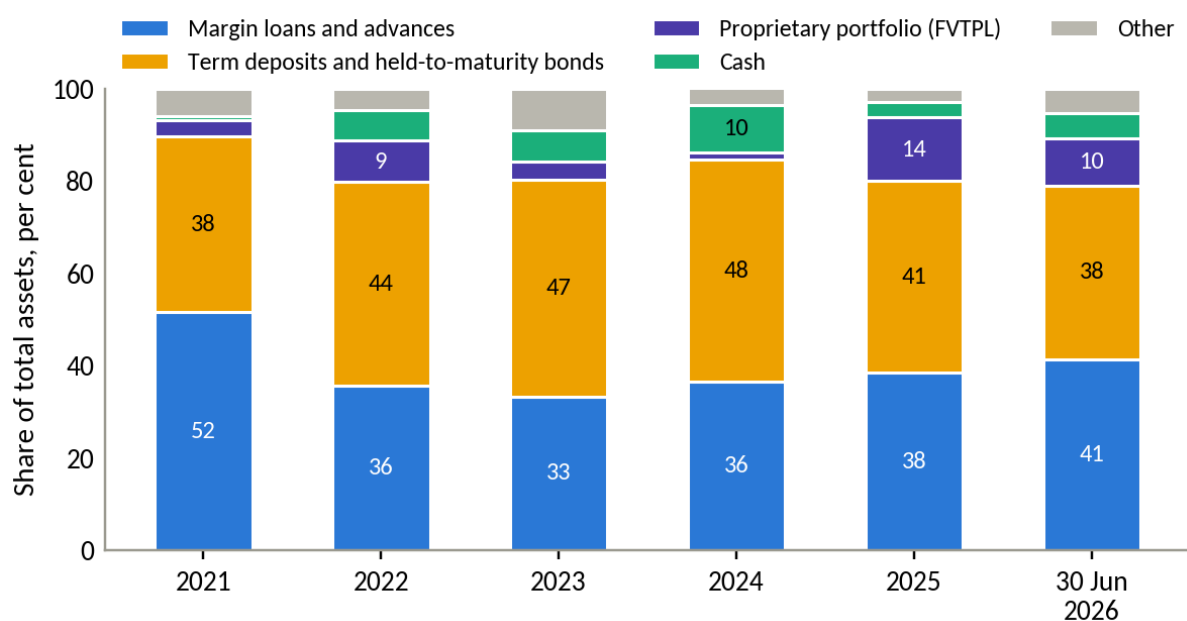
Source: filed statements of 42 brokers via Vietcap Securities (2026); authors' calculations. Brokers are the nine with the highest brokerage revenue. 19 of the 42 brokers made a loss after direct costs; the three largest losses were DNSE (-44.5); PSI (-17.1); KAFI (-16.8).

Figure A8. Yield on margin loans and on deposits and bonds held to maturity, against the estimated cost of funding



Source: DNSE filings, authors' calculations. Yields are annualised quarterly income over the average of opening and closing balances.

Figure A9. Composition of DNSE total assets



Source: DNSE filings, authors' calculations.

Table A6. Funding cost and balance-sheet structure at 30 June 2026: DNSE and eight large brokers

Broker	Parent bank	Estimated cost of funds, Q2 2026, %	Deposits and HTM bonds, % of total assets	Loans, % of equity	Short-term loans, % of borrowing
DNSE	none	6.5	37.6	116	86
VPS	none	5.1	4.3	100	68
SSI	none	6.1	8.6	99	100
TCBS	Techcombank	7.8	4.6	113	94
VPBankS	VPBank	6.8	6.5	107	100
MBS	MB	6.8	16.1	141	87

Broker	Parent bank	Estimated cost of funds, Q2 2026, %	Deposits and HTM bonds, % of total assets	Loans, % of equity	Short-term loans, % of borrowing
HSC	none	7.9	0.9	198	100
Vietcap	none	6.4	0.8	100	100
VNDirect	none	n.m.	22.2	60	91

Source: filed statements via Vietcap Securities (2026); DNSE (2026a), note 8(b), for pledged assets; authors' calculations. The cost of funds is estimated with the same method for every firm: interest expense plus template line 24, less the rise in the allowance for loan losses, annualised over average borrowings and bonds. n.m.: not meaningful, as VNDirect's quarterly estimate falls below 1 per cent. At 30 June 2026 DNSE had pledged VND 4,257 billion of term deposits and bonds with a face value of VND 1,050 billion, 93 per cent of its held-to-maturity assets, as collateral for bank loans. Bank-owned brokers with filed statements (TCBS, VPBankS, MBS, BSI, CTS, Agriseco, LPBS and ABS) supplied 55 per cent of the rise in lending across all filers in the second quarter of 2026; a press tally of the top 20 brokers gives 62 per cent (Vietstock, 2026g).

Table A7. Summary of findings and their business implications

Finding	Main evidence	Evidence type	Implication
1. DNSE wins accounts but not money	12.7% of accounts and 19% of 2025 openings against 2.3–3.5% of investor cash, 1.4–1.8% of lending and 0.6–0.8% of profit; 5.7% of accounts active in December 2025; assets per account down 9.5% in 2025	Measured and derived	Value is lost after the account is opened
2. The gap is specific to DNSE	VPS lends 5 times and TCBS 12 times more per account; about 34% of TCBS customers trade monthly; bonus complaints in 5.6% of DNSE reviews against 0.7% at VPS	Measured; reviews self-selected	Not explained by dormant accounts, the zero-fee app model or the lack of a parent bank
3. Revenue grows while core profit stands still	Revenue 3.2 times from 2022 to 2025; core profit VND 128–221 billion a year; VND 102 of extra cost per VND 100 of extra core revenue in H1 2026	Measured	Growth in activity does not create value on its own
4. Brokerage and funding absorb the growth	52% of the H1 2026 rise in core costs from funding, 42% from brokerage, 6% from administration; brokerage below direct cost for 16 quarters and the largest brokerage loss among 42 brokers	Measured	Cost action must target per-trade costs and funding structure, not overheads
5. Capital is not the constraint	Loans at 116% of equity against a 200% ceiling; 38% of assets in deposits and bonds, 93% of them pledged, earning about their funding cost	Measured	The binding constraint is customer money

Source: Section 2.

Appendix B. Exhibits for the discussion and recommendation

Appendix B holds the figures and tables behind Sections 3 and 4, in the order in which the text cites them.

Table B1. Evidence on the customer lifecycle and the gaps to close in Round 3

Stage	Available evidence	What it shows	Measure needed from internal data
Sign-up	518,514 accounts in 2025; 16 to 34% of the new accounts opened in the market in each quarter of 2025	Acquisition works	Cost per account by channel and campaign
Identity verification (eKYC)	21% of negative reviews on onboarding (NFC chip reading, one-time passwords, photo checks); peaks in 2021, 2022 and 2025	Recurring friction	Completion rate and time to verify, by device and channel
First funding	Assets per account fell 9.5% in 2025 while accounts grew 52%; June 2025 complaints that a reward required a VND 2 million deposit	The weakest stage	Share of new accounts funded within 30 days, and amount
First trade and activity	85,739 active users in December 2025, 5.7% of accounts, up from 41,900 a year earlier; about 34% at TCBS (Table D2)	Most accounts stay idle	First-trade rate; active rate by cohort month
Retention at 30 to 90 days	Cash per account fell 32% in the second quarter of 2026, in line with the industry	Money leaves when rates rise	Dormancy at 30, 60 and 90 days; balance retention
Second product	Idle-cash product in 3 of 670 reviews; Ensa used by 72,000 customers in 2025	Depth is thin	Products held per funded customer

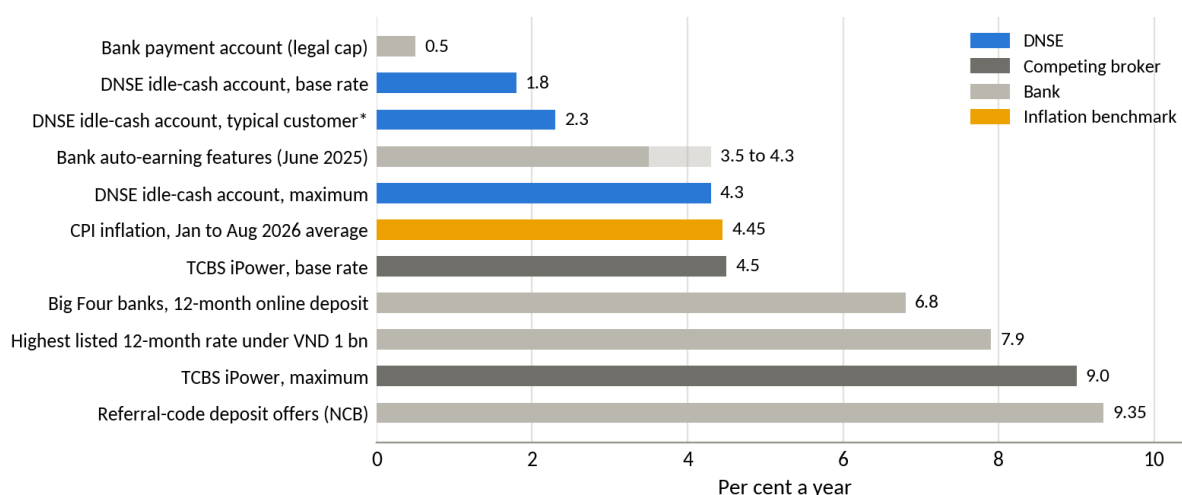
Source: DNSE releases; Section 2; Dân trí (2026a) on the draft circular.

Table B2. Five-whys analysis of the balance gap

Step	Question and answer	Evidence
Symptom	DNSE holds 12.7% of accounts but 2.3–3.5% of investor cash and 1.4–1.8% of margin lending, and only 5.7% of accounts were active in December 2025	Figure 1; DNSE annual report 2025
Why 1	Why do accounts stay small? Hypothesis: many customers open an account for a reward and deposit only what the reward requires	June 2025 complaints about a VND 100,000 reward that required a VND 2 million deposit; DNSE reviews raise bonus terms about eight times as often as VPS reviews
Why 2	Why do reward seekers dominate the intake? Hypothesis: incentives pay for opening an account and a minimum deposit, and marketing targets young first-time investors	Reward waves in the review series (late 2024, June 2025); Gen Z price board, trading contests and social media content
Why 3	Why does money not stay after the reward? Measured: the product gives no competitive reason to keep cash on the platform	Idle cash earns 2.1 to 2.3% for a typical customer against 6.0% at TCBS iPower for the same balance (4.5% base rate) and 3.5 to 4.3% on banks' automatic-earning accounts; no automatic saving; trading-first design
Why 4	Why has the product not been built? Hypothesis: DNSE's goals and public measures centre on accounts, market share and speed	Published indicators are accounts, new-account share, derivatives share, active users and order speed of 3.9 milliseconds; balances appear only as total customer assets, without per-account or funded-account figures
Root cause	DNSE earns through lending and trading, which need customer balances, but it measures and rewards acquisition. To be confirmed with internal targets in Round 3	Core profit flat since 2022 while accounts tripled from the end of 2023; lending per account falling

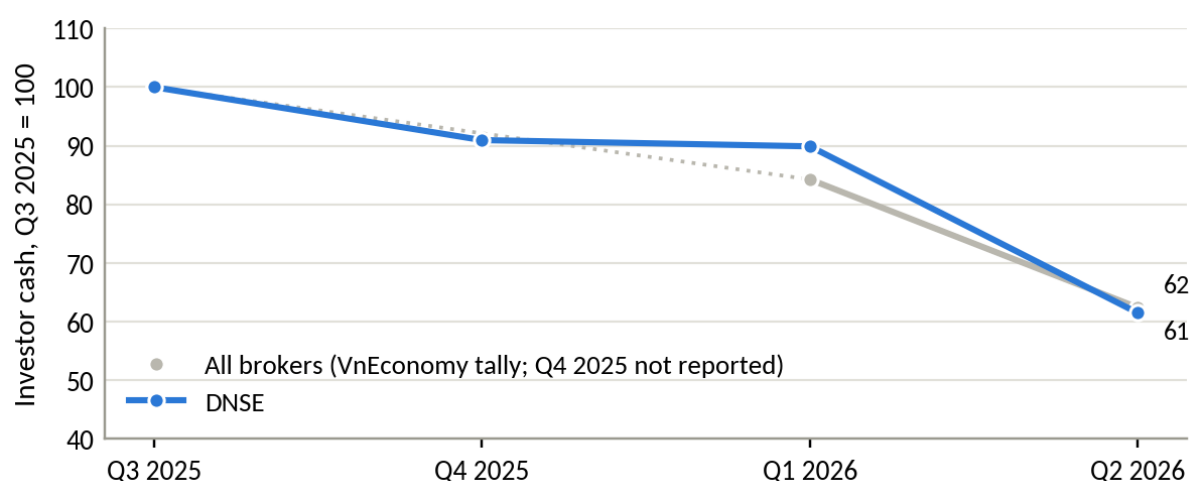
Source: authors' analysis of Sections 2 and 3; Vietstock (2025c) on the Gen Z price board.

Figure B1. Returns available to a Vietnamese saver's idle cash, September 2026



Source: DNSE (2026b) and TCBS (2026a) product pages, accessed 24 September 2026; DNSE (2025) comparison of bank auto-earning products; VietnamNet (2026) and VnExpress (2026c) bank rate surveys; Báo Đầu thầu (2026). * A customer holding VND 1 million to 500 million with trading value in the same band.

Figure B2. Investor cash held at brokers, indexed to the third quarter of 2025



Source: VnEconomy (2026b) tally of investor deposits at securities firms; DNSE filings. The industry figure for the fourth quarter of 2025 was not reported.

Table B3. Macroeconomic and banking indicators relevant to household savings, 2025 and 2026

Indicator	Value	Period
GDP growth	8.18% (Q2 8.39%)	First half of 2026
Consumer price inflation, average	4.45% (core 4.24%)	January to August 2026
Credit growth against deposit growth	19.0% against 11.4%	2025
Credit growth, year to date	10.24%, about VND 20.5 quadrillion outstanding	To 28 August 2026
Household deposits at banks	Above VND 11 quadrillion, +7.1% in six months	June 2026
Individual payment account balances	About VND 1.22 quadrillion in 256.7 million accounts, against about VND 1.35 quadrillion a year earlier	June 2026
12-month deposit rate, Big Four state banks	6.8%	September 2026

Indicator	Value	Period
Highest listed 12-month rate for deposits below VND 1 billion	7.9%	September 2026
Change in 12-month deposit rates at large banks since January	About +2.5 percentage points	January to July 2026
Bank-owned brokers' share of the rise in margin lending	55% (all filed statements); 62% (press tally of the top 20)	Q2 2026

Source: National Statistics Office via Chinhphu.vn (2026) and Báo Đầu thầu (2026); State Bank of Vietnam via Diễn đàn Doanh nghiệp (2026), Thị trường Tài chính Tiền tệ (2026b), Vietstock (2026i) and VietnamPlus (2026); FiiRatings (2026); VnEconomy (2026b); VietnamNet (2026); VnExpress (2026c); Vietstock (2026g); filed statements via Vietcap Securities (2026).

Table B4. Where Vietnamese savers keep money, mid-2026

Pool	Value, VND trillion	Multiple of DNSE investor cash
Household deposits at banks (June 2026)	above 11,000	about 5,600
Individual payment accounts at banks (June 2026)	about 1,220	about 620
Investor cash at all securities firms (June 2026)	86.6	44
DNSE customer assets (December 2025)	53.5	27
DNSE investor cash (June 2026)	1.96	1

Source: Vietstock (2026i); VietnamPlus (2026); VnEconomy (2026b); DNSE filings and releases.

Table B5. Competitive map of Vietnamese retail brokerage business models

Model	Examples	How it earns	Strength	Weakness
Bank-affiliated balance-sheet brokers	TCBS, VPBankS, MBS, SHS	Margin lending, bond distribution, investment banking	Cheap funding, capital, bank customers	Less focus on first-time and young investors
Independent full-service brokers	SSI, HSC, Vietcap, VNDirect	Margin, institutional brokerage, advisory	Research, institutional clients, brand	Higher cost to serve retail
Retail trading platforms	VPS	Retail brokerage, derivatives, margin	Largest retail and derivatives share	HOSE share fell to 12.61% in Q2 2026, lowest in 22 quarters
Digital zero-fee challengers	DNSE, Pinetree	Margin and derivatives	Low cost, fast technology, young customers	Small balances, no bank parent, trust gaps
Digital wealth and fund platforms	Independent fund and savings apps	Fees on funds, bonds and savings products	Low minimums, periodic investing, goal-based design	Mostly fee income; no large trading or margin platform
Banks' own savings features	Techcombank, VPBank, VIB	Deposit spread	Salary accounts, trust, 3.5 to 4.3% auto-earning (2025)	Limited investment choice

Source: company releases and statements; Vietstock (2026e); CafeF (2026b); DNSE (2025); authors' assessment.

Table B6. Comparable business models abroad and their lessons for DNSE

Firm and market	How it grew	How it earns money	Lesson for DNSE
Robinhood, United States	Zero commissions since its 2015 launch; 27.0 million funded customers in 2025	Trading 59%, net interest 34%, subscriptions and other 7% of USD 4.5 billion revenue in 2025	Growth after 2021 came from assets. Net deposits reached USD 68 billion in 2025 (35% of opening assets), helped by retirement accounts, a paid tier with a higher cash yield and a bank account with direct deposit. A USD 70 million FINRA penalty in 2021 for outages and misleading information preceded the shift
Trade Republic, Germany and Europe	EUR 1 trades and free ETF savings plans	Interest on cash and trading	Passing the full central bank rate on uninvested cash and automating savings plans took customer assets past EUR 150 billion by October 2025; EUR 2.5 billion of interest was passed to customers from 2023
Zerodha and Groww, India	Flat or zero fees; Groww began as a mutual fund platform in 2016	Zerodha earned 70 to 90% of its income from futures and options	After the regulator tightened derivatives trading in late 2024, derivatives turnover fell 29% and Zerodha's revenue fell from INR 10,000 crore to 8,500 crore. Groww, with monthly fund plans at its base, raised profit 12% in the quarter when peers fell. Monthly SIP inflows reached INR 29,529 crore in October 2025
SBI and Rakuten Securities, Japan	Zero commissions on domestic shares from October 2023, plus the tax-free NISA account from 2024	Balances, fund distribution and group banking	NISA accounts reached 26.96 million and cumulative purchases JPY 63 trillion by June 2025. Rakuten's automatic sweep between its bank and broker passed 7 million accounts in August 2026 and pays a preferential deposit rate
Futu, Hong Kong	Low commissions and a strong community	Brokerage 46%, interest 46% of revenue in 2025	Only 3.37 million of 29.2 million users are funded (11.5%), yet client assets reached HKD 1.23 trillion, with HKD 180 billion in wealth management products
DNSE, Vietnam	Zero fees on shares; 1.7 million accounts	Lending 40%, own-account investments 32%, brokerage 26% of revenue in H1 2026	Has the reach and the technology; lacks a competitive cash product, automated saving and asset-based incentives

Source: Robinhood Markets (2026); FINRA (2021); Trade Republic (2025); Inc42 (2025); AMFI (2025); Financial Services Agency (2026); Rakuten Group (2026); Futu Holdings (2026a).

Table B7. Transferability of foreign designs to Vietnam

Design	Transferable	Condition in Vietnam
Market-rate yield on uninvested cash	Yes	Deliver through a bank sweep or a licensed money market fund; legal structure to be confirmed with the SSC
Automatic monthly investment plans	Yes	Periodic fund subscriptions and bond products from VND 1 million already exist
Salary-linked transfers	Partly	Wages arrive at banks; a pull on payday requires bank open interfaces (standard by March 2027) or ZaloPay
Asset-based rewards	Yes	Pay rewards on funding, saving and transferred portfolios instead of sign-ups
Paid subscription tier	Later	Useful once a funded base exists
Payment for order flow	No	Order-driven exchanges
Tax-advantaged accounts	No, for now	Requires policy change; DNSE can support industry proposals
Bank account with direct deposit	No	Securities firms cannot take deposits; partner banks can

Source: authors' assessment based on Table B6 and the Vietnamese regulation cited in Section 4.1.

Table B8. Scoring of candidate target markets

Candidate market	Wallet per customer (25%)	Reachable scale (20%)	Fit with balance-based revenue (20%)	DNSE's right to win (15%)	Low competitive intensity (10%)	Low conduct and regulatory risk (10%)	Weighted	Equal
Salaried mass-affluent adults (employed, secondary-educated, upper 60% income)	4	5	5	3	3	4	4.15	4.00
Affluent and high-net-worth investors	5	1	4	1	1	4	2.90	2.67
Household businesses	3	4	2	1	2	3	2.60	2.50
Young first-time investors (15 to 24)	1	3	2	5	2	2	2.40	2.50
Active derivatives traders	2	1	2	5	2	1	2.15	2.17

Source: authors' assessment. Scores from 1 (weak) to 5 (strong). The weighted total uses the weights shown; the equal-weight total is a robustness check.

Table B9. Scope of the business problem for Round 3

Dimension	In scope	Out of scope for now
Customer segment	Salaried adults, roughly 22 to 40, in the upper 60% of the income distribution. The first wave comes from DNSE's own unfunded or low-balance accounts held by working customers, including Gen Z customers who have started work	Students without income, affluent advisory clients, institutional clients, household businesses
Journey stage	The first 90 days after an account is opened, from identity verification to first funding and the third payday, and the matching restart journey for dormant accounts	Brand marketing, trading features, derivatives, after-sales service beyond balance retention
Solution depth	Mechanism, value logic, main assumptions and measures of success	Detailed feature design, screens, pricing tables and budgets, which Round 3 will develop

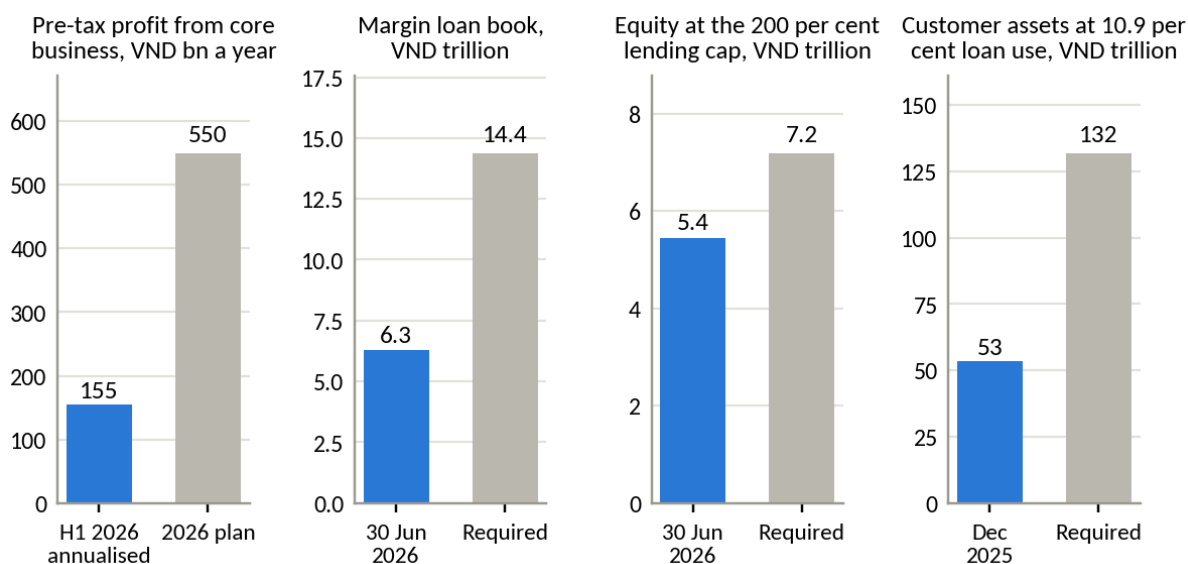
Source: authors' assessment.

Table B10. Prioritisation of candidate business problems

Candidate problem	Scale anchor	Scale (25%)	Urgency (15%)	Strategic relevance (20%)	Data support (20%)	Control (20%)	Weighted	Equal
Balance gap (accounts not converted into funded, retained relationships)	2026 plan gap of VND 395 billion; VND 83 billion a year per extra VND 1 million lent per account	5	4	5	5	4	4.65	4.60
Trust and reliability deficit	Indirect; blocks conversion of the base	3	4	4	4	5	3.95	4.00
Loss-making brokerage	About VND 89 billion a year below direct cost	3	3	3	5	4	3.60	3.60
Derivatives concentration and regulatory exposure	Three services stopped in August 2026; Indian turnover fell 29% after new rules	3	4	4	4	2	3.35	3.40
Control and conduct weaknesses	Fine of VND 802.5 million; insider lending over 30 months; reputational cost not measurable	2	4	3	3	5	3.30	3.40
Earnings dependent on proprietary trading	Swings of about VND 150 billion a year	4	2	2	5	3	3.30	3.20
Rising funding cost and pledged deposits	About VND 130 billion a year from a 1.4-point rise in the cost of funds	4	4	3	3	2	3.20	3.20

Source: authors' assessment based on Sections 2 and 3. Scores from 1 (weak) to 5 (strong). Scale anchors are annual pre-tax profit effects estimated from DNSE filings where possible.

Figure B3. What the 2026 profit plan implies for loans, equity and customer assets



Source: DNSE filings and 2026 plan; authors' calculations. The calculation assumes that all additional profit comes from lending at the first-half 2026 net spread of 4.88 points, with no change in other lines. It is an order-of-magnitude illustration.

Table B11. Business problem statement

Element	Statement
Context	DNSE opened one in five of Vietnam's new securities accounts in 2025 and serves 1.7 million customers. Its income comes from lending, trading and its balance sheet, all of which depend on customer money held on the platform
Quantified gap	DNSE holds 12.7% of accounts but 2.3–3.5% of investor cash, 1.4–1.8% of margin lending and 0.6–0.8% of quarterly industry profit; 5.7% of accounts were active in December 2025; assets per account fell 9.5% in 2025
Economic impact	Core pre-tax profit has stayed between VND 128 and 221 billion a year since 2022 while revenue tripled; each extra VND 100 of core revenue brought VND 102 of cost in H1 2026. Each additional VND 1 million lent per account is worth about VND 83 billion of pre-tax profit a year. The 2026 plan implies a loan book 2.3 times the current one
Strategic urgency	Deposit rates have risen about 2.5 points in 2026 and cash is leaving brokers; bank-owned brokers supplied more than half of margin growth in the second quarter; open banking interfaces become standard by March 2027, after which every competitor can link salary accounts
Problem	DNSE converts sign-ups into funded, retained relationships at a low rate, above all in the first 90 days, because its incentives reward opening accounts and its products give salaried customers no competitive, trusted reason to keep money on the platform

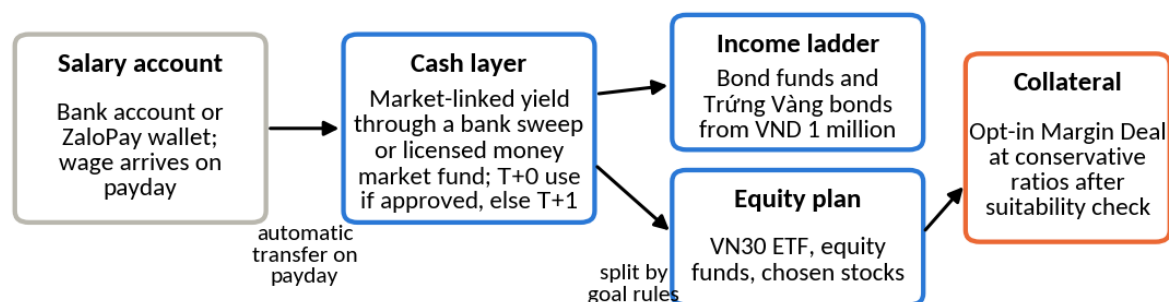
Source: Sections 2 and 3.

Table B12. Strategic alternatives assessed against the balance gap

Alternative	Impact on funded balances (30%)	Profit potential by 2028 (20%)	Low capital and cost need (15%)	Low execution and regulatory risk (15%)	Fit with DNSE capabilities (10%)	Evidence support (10%)	Weighted	Equal
B. Payday Portfolio, a salary-linked savings-to-investing layer	5	3	3	3	4	5	3.90	3.83
D. Upmarket advisory tier for affluent investors	4	4	2	3	1	3	3.15	2.83
E. Distribution alliance with a bank or e-wallet	3	3	4	2	3	3	3.00	3.00
C. Derivatives-to-shares bridge for traders on same-day trading	2	3	4	1	5	2	2.65	2.83
F. Reintroduce trading fees	1	3	5	2	1	2	2.25	2.33
A. Continue acquisition-led growth	1	1	3	4	5	1	2.15	2.50

Source: authors' assessment. Scores from 1 (weak) to 5 (strong); for cost and risk, a higher score means lower cost or lower risk.

Figure B4. How Payday Portfolio works



Revenue for DNSE: spread or distribution fees on the cash layer, fund distribution and later management fees, interest on opt-in margin loans, trading fees, and lower churn from customers who hold assets

Trust layer applied across every step

No closure fee. Rewards paid on funding and saving, never on sign-up alone. Plain-language terms.
Product reported to the SSC before launch. Published uptime and onboarding success rates.
Data deletion on request under the Personal Data Protection Law in force since 1 January 2026.

Source: authors' design, drawing on Sections 2 and 3; National Assembly of Vietnam (2025) on the Personal Data Protection Law.

Table B13. The first 90 days of a new DNSE customer, today and under Payday Portfolio

Moment	Today	Under Payday Portfolio
Day 0, sign-up	Account opened, often in response to a cash reward; identity checks by chip reading and photos	Account opened through VNeID; the first screen asks for a savings goal and a payday amount
First funding	Deposit set by the reward condition (for example VND 2 million); no reason to add more	First transfer on the next payday; reward paid only on money that stays
Idle cash	Earns 2.1 to 2.3% unless the balance exceeds VND 500 million	Earns a market-linked return paid by the partner bank or fund; usable the same day if the regulator approves, otherwise the next day
Paydays 2 and 3	No prompt; cash drifts back to banks as deposit rates rise	Automatic transfer; ladder allocation by goal; progress shown against the goal
Day 90	Most accounts inactive (5.7% of accounts were active in December 2025)	Review of goal and allocation; invitation to the equity plan; margin offered only after a suitability check
Closure	VND 100,000 fee reported by customers; slow cancellation	Free and immediate; data deleted on request

Source: authors' design; current journey reconstructed from DNSE product pages and customer reviews.

Table B14. Evidence behind each design choice

Design choice	Evidence in Vietnam	Lesson abroad
Target salaried adults and start with DNSE's own accounts	The three leading Findex segments rank first to fourth under four weightings; 40 to 50% receive wages into an account; 94% of DNSE accounts used no product in December 2025	Groww built its base on monthly fund plans before trading
Act in the first 90 days	Assets per account fell 9.5% in 2025 while accounts grew 52%; complaints cluster at identity checks and first deposits	Robinhood tracks funded customers and net deposits, the measures that open and close this stage
Market-linked cash yield without trading conditions	DNSE pays 2.1 to 2.3% to typical customers against 6.0% at TCBS for the same balance (4.5% base) and 3.5 to 4.3% on bank auto-earning accounts; cash at brokers fell 38% in three quarters	Trade Republic passed the full central bank rate on cash and gathered EUR 150 billion; Rakuten's bank sweep passed 7 million accounts
Automatic payday transfers	Wages arrive in bank accounts; open banking standards by March 2027; ZaloPay link already live	Robinhood's direct deposit; India's SIPs of INR 29.5 thousand crore a month
Ladder into bonds and funds	TCBS earns most non-lending income from distribution; 75% of investors use only traditional channels and 81% want guidance	Futu holds HKD 180 billion in wealth products; Trade Republic added bond ETFs from EUR 1
Collateral only by opt-in	Lending is DNSE's widest margin; the August 2026 penalty and derivatives risk argue for prudence	India's derivatives curbs cut broker revenue sharply
Trust layer	Trust complaints attract 43% of helpful votes on negative reviews; 34% of investors fear hidden fees; new data protection law	Robinhood's 2021 penalty for outages and misleading information preceded its shift to savings products

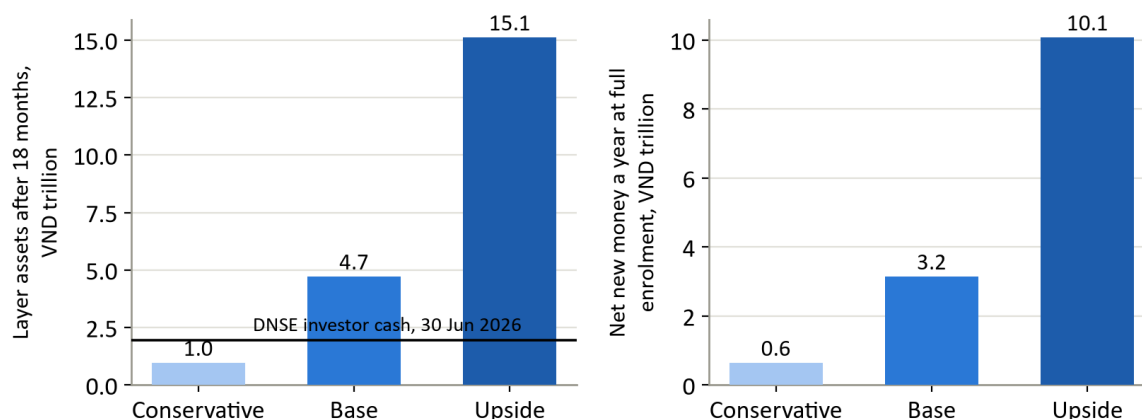
Source: Sections 2 and 3; TCBS (2026b); Nhân Dân (2025); VnEconomy (2025); and the sources of Table B6.

Table B15. Illustrative outcomes of Payday Portfolio 18 months after launch

Assumption or outcome	Conservative	Base	Upside
Savers enrolled	60,000	150,000	300,000
Average monthly contribution, VND million	1.5	2.5	3.5
Share of contributions kept on the platform	60%	70%	80%
Assets per saver after 18 months, VND million	16.2	31.5	50.4
Layer assets, VND trillion	1.0	4.7	15.1
Net new money a year at full enrolment, VND trillion	0.6	3.2	10.1
Fee and spread yield on layer assets	0.5%	0.8%	1.0%
Annual fee and spread revenue from layer assets, VND billion	5	38	151
Margin loans backed by layer assets (10, 15 and 20% of assets), VND trillion	0.1	0.7	3.0
Net lending income at a 4.9-point spread, VND billion	5	35	148
Fees and lending income per saver a year, VND thousand	160	483	996
Layer assets as a multiple of DNSE investor cash in June 2026	0.5	2.4	7.7

Source: authors' projections. All inputs are assumptions to be validated in Round 3. The revenue yield covers fund distribution fees and any cash-layer spread, net of rewards; opt-in margin lending is shown separately at the first-half 2026 net spread. The costs of the yield bonus, marketing and technology are not included and are estimated in Round 3 against the incremental balances (test 4).

Figure B5. Layer assets and annual net new money under three scenarios



Source: as for Table B15.

Table B16. Feasibility conditions for Payday Portfolio

Condition	Status	Detail
Product components	In place	Idle-cash account, Trúng Vàng bonds from VND 1 million, Margin Deal, VN30 ETF trading, Lightspeed interface
Technology	In place	Order processing in about 4 milliseconds; Lightspeed API; ZaloPay partnership since 2023; a new data centre planned for 2026
Funding and capital	In place	Lending at 116% of equity against a 200% ceiling; VND 3.5 trillion bond programme approved in March 2026
Cash layer structure	To be decided	Bank sweep or licensed money market fund; legal basis and pass-through of yield to be confirmed
Fund distribution and management	Partial	A partner fund manager is needed now; the board plans to establish or acquire a fund manager, a step delayed by high valuations
Salary link at scale	Partial	ZaloPay now; bank open interfaces standard by March 2027
Regulatory clearance	Required	Prior report to the SSC, as the August 2026 penalty showed; the draft biometric circular affects onboarding and withdrawals
Reliability of the app and payday transfers	Decision needed	Targets for uptime, crash-free sessions and transfer success before launch; App Store reviewers cite crashes, login and onboarding in 51% of complaints
Trust and control changes	Decision needed	Remove the closure fee; replace sign-up rewards with funding rewards; publish reliability data; close the control gaps found by the 2026 penalty

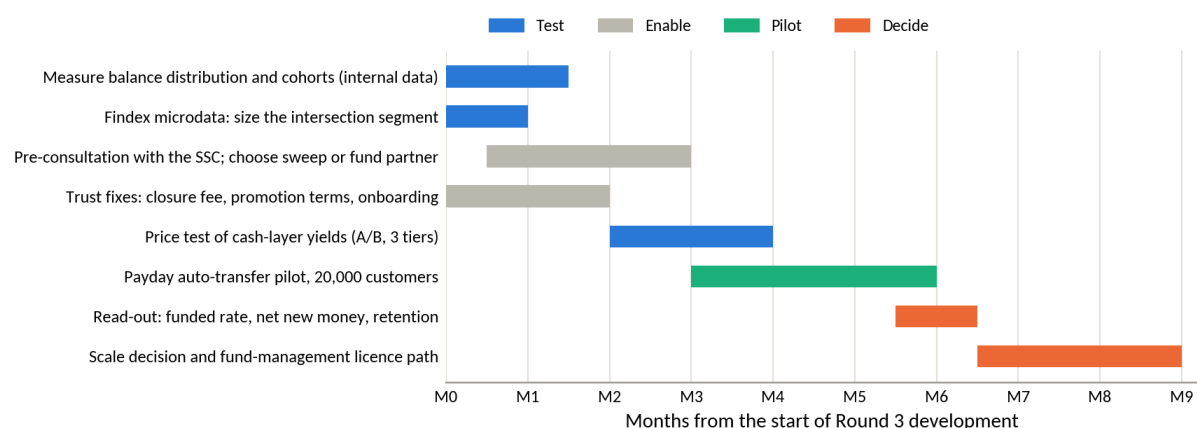
Source: DNSE product pages and releases; Vietstock (2026b); Thời báo Tài chính Việt Nam (2026); State Bank of Vietnam (2024); Dân trí (2026a); authors' assessment.

Table B17. Assumptions, tests and measures for Round 3

No.	Assumption	Priority	Test	Measure and threshold
1	Most DNSE accounts hold little money, and the gap concentrates in reward-driven cohorts	High	Distribution of balances and cohort curves from internal data, by acquisition channel and reward	Share of accounts funded within 30 days; balance at day 90 by cohort
2	The target segment is large inside DNSE's base and in the population	High	Findex microdata for the intersection of employed, secondary-educated, upper-income adults aged 22 to 40; internal age and salary-link data	Segment size in millions; share of DNSE accounts in segment
3	A compliant structure can pay a market-linked yield	High	Pre-consultation with the SSC; term sheets from two bank or fund partners	Written confirmation; net yield after fees
4	Savers respond to the yield enough to cover its cost	High	Randomised test of three yield tiers among matched customers	Incremental balance per customer against cost of yield
5	Customers will set up payday transfers	High	Pilot with 20,000 eligible customers, randomised against the current journey	Enrolment of 25% or more within 60 days; 70% or more of contributions kept at day 90; average contribution of VND 2 million or more
6	Balances lead to more lending and trading	High	Regression of margin balances on customer assets, using the quarterly series from 2021 and pilot data	Loans per VND of saver assets; products per funded customer
7	The trust package reduces complaints and closures	Medium	Before and after comparison of review themes, closure requests and complaint handling times	Share of negative reviews on deception, bonus terms or closure below 10% (from 24%)

Source: authors' design. Thresholds are proposals to be agreed with DNSE management.

Figure B6. Validation roadmap for Round 3



Source: authors' design.

Appendix C. DNSE financial data

The tables below summarise the 395 line items of DNSE's filed statements used in the analysis. Annual figures are sums of quarters for flows and period-end values for balances. Every value was recomputed from the source data for this version and matches.

Table C1. DNSE income statement summary, 2021 to the first half of 2026 (VND billion)

Item	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	H1 2026
Operating revenue	180.7	452.1	714.5	807.4	1,457.9	848.2
Interest on margin loans and advances	42.7	223.1	286.2	360.5	555.8	336.1
Interest on deposits and bonds held to maturity	20.1	112.9	196.0	245.0	303.9	193.4
Brokerage revenue	90.0	84.8	67.6	144.8	404.0	222.1
Gains on financial assets at fair value	20.4	18.7	157.9	47.9	171.4	77.2
Direct brokerage cost	51.5	74.4	111.1	174.8	464.9	266.5
Losses on financial assets at fair value	24.8	80.0	(0.2)	41.1	25.2	43.4
Interest expense	2.7	29.8	22.1	28.0	66.8	75.2
Template line 24 (provisions and borrowing cost of the loan book)	21.2	142.4	211.5	182.6	363.0	248.9
Administrative expenses	14.8	37.1	94.3	151.9	181.4	95.4
Pre-tax profit	68.2	95.0	285.6	227.5	340.2	111.6
Net proprietary result	(4.4)	(61.3)	158.0	6.8	146.2	33.9
Core pre-tax profit	72.5	156.3	127.6	220.7	194.0	77.7
Profit after tax	54.5	77.8	229.0	181.8	272.5	93.1

Source: DNSE filed statements via Vietcap Securities (2026); first half of 2026 from the statements reviewed by KPMG; authors' calculations. Costs are shown as positive amounts. Core pre-tax profit excludes the net result on financial assets at fair value through profit or loss. Negative values are in parentheses.

Table C2. DNSE balance sheet and key ratios, 2021 to 30 June 2026

Item	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	Jun 2026
Margin loans and advances	1,192	2,280	2,483	3,882	5,832	6,303
Deposits and bonds held to maturity	883	2,824	3,495	5,103	6,266	5,714
Financial assets at fair value	84	576	299	167	2,086	1,540
Cash and equivalents	21	432	505	1,093	511	842
Total assets	2,315	6,409	7,446	10,637	15,139	15,208
Borrowings and bonds	1,224	2,735	3,643	6,494	10,600	9,446
Owners' equity	1,059	3,136	3,305	4,030	4,302	5,440
Investor cash held off balance sheet	435	251	790	1,340	2,903	1,961
Pre-tax margin, %	37.7	21.0	40.0	28.2	23.3	13.2
Brokerage revenue as % of direct cost	174.9	114.0	60.9	82.8	86.9	83.3
Return on equity, %	8.9	3.7	7.1	5.0	6.5	3.8
Loans as % of equity	112.6	72.7	75.1	96.3	135.6	115.9
Yield on margin loans, %	13.0	12.0	11.9	10.1	11.1	11.2
Estimated cost of funds, %	6.5	6.8	7.3	4.1	5.1	6.3
Net interest margin, %	6.2	5.4	4.8	5.0	4.2	3.5

Source: DNSE filed statements via Vietcap Securities (2026); authors' calculations. Balances are at the end of each period. Yields, cost of funds and net interest margin are averages of annualised quarterly values; the cost of funds is estimated as interest expense plus template line 24, less the rise in the allowance for loan losses, over average borrowings. Return on equity for the first half of 2026 is annualised.

Table C3. DNSE quarterly indicators, first quarter of 2024 to second quarter of 2026

Indicator	Q1 24	Q2 24	Q3 24	Q4 24	Q1 25	Q2 25	Q3 25	Q4 25	Q1 26	Q2 26
Operating revenue	182	198	194	234	243	290	489	435	395	453
Pre-tax profit	88	43	55	42	66	91	171	12	14	97

Indicator	Q1 24	Q2 24	Q3 24	Q4 24	Q1 25	Q2 25	Q3 25	Q4 25	Q1 26	Q2 26
Core pre-tax profit	68	57	54	42	45	37	99	13	24	54
Net proprietary result	20	(14)	1	0	21	54	72	(1)	(10)	43
Brokerage revenue	32	40	33	39	49	74	156	125	120	103
Direct brokerage cost	39	45	41	50	61	84	170	150	138	129
Margin loans and advances	3,409	3,598	4,102	3,882	4,276	5,053	5,750	5,832	5,910	6,303
Investor cash	1,278	1,486	1,637	1,340	429	2,516	3,192	2,903	2,869	1,961
Yield on margin loans, %	10.1	10.0	9.7	10.6	10.2	10.7	12.7	10.8	10.1	12.3
Cost of funds, %	4.5	3.6	3.6	4.6	4.6	4.6	5.2	5.7	6.1	6.5
Net interest margin, %	4.9	5.5	4.8	4.7	4.2	3.9	5.1	3.4	2.8	4.1
Fee income, % of revenue	18.9	21.2	18.2	18.1	21.3	26.8	33.0	31.2	31.8	25.5

Source: DNSE filed statements via Vietcap Securities (2026); authors' calculations. VND billion unless stated. Q2 2026 pre-tax profit is the reviewed half year less the first quarter. Negative values are in parentheses.

Appendix D. Market and industry data

Table D1 lists the share measures behind Figure 1 with their denominators, including both industry totals where they differ. Table D2 compares the share of accounts that are active or funded at brokers in Vietnam and abroad that publish such a measure.

Table D1. DNSE's position on eight measures, 2025 to mid-2026

Measure	DNSE	Market total	DNSE share, %	Ratio to account share
Securities accounts, 31 December 2025	1,512,920	11,871,933 (VSDC)	12.74	1.00
New accounts opened, 2025	518,514	2,681,838 (VSDC)	19.33	1.52
Securities accounts, 30 June 2026	about 1.70 million	13,430,517 (VSDC)	12.66	1.00
Derivatives brokerage, Q2 2026	second place	HNX announcement	25.38	2.00
Listed-share brokerage on HNX, Q2 2026	eighth place	HNX announcement	2.88	0.23
Investor cash at brokers, 30 June 2026	VND 1,961 billion	VND 86.6 trillion (press tally); VND 56.4 trillion (filed statements)	2.26 to 3.48	0.18 to 0.27
Margin lending, 30 June 2026	VND 6,303 billion	VND 453.8 trillion (press tally, with advances); VND 345.3 trillion (filed statements)	1.39 to 1.83	0.11 to 0.14
Pre-tax profit, Q2 2026	VND 97.4 billion	VND 15,200 billion (77 brokers, press tally); VND 11,871 billion (filed statements)	0.64 to 0.82	0.05 to 0.06

Source: VSDC annual report 2025 and account statistics; DNSE (2026d); Hanoi Stock Exchange (2026); VnEconomy (2026b); Vietstock (2026g); CafeF (2026d); filed statements via Vietcap Securities (2026); authors' calculations. Filed-statement totals sum the brokers in Vietcap's data service, DNSE included. The ratio to account share divides each share by 12.7 per cent. HNX shares are shares of traded value on HNX only.

Table D2. Share of accounts that are active or funded, brokers that publish a measure

Broker and model	Base	Active or funded	Share, %	Measure and date
DNSE. Vietnam; zero-fee app, no branches	1,512,920 accounts, 31 December 2025	85,739 customers using at least one product	5.7	Monthly, December 2025 (4.2 in December 2024)
TCBS. Vietnam; zero-fee, 99% of accounts opened online	1,203,039 customers, 31 December 2025	About 410,000 customers trading on TCInvest	about 34	Monthly, December 2025; read from a chart
VNDirect. Vietnam; branches and app	About 1 million customers, 31 December 2025	134,507 individual customers using a product	13.5 or less	2025, window not stated; sum of three product tiers
SSI, Digital Sales channel. Vietnam; online channel of a full-service broker	Customers of the channel (number not disclosed)	Customers with a trade in the past 90 days	19.2	90 days, 2025
Robinhood. United States; commission-free app	23.4 million funded customers, December 2023	10.9 million monthly active users	47	Monthly, counts logging in; last disclosed for the fourth quarter of 2023
Futu (moomoo). Hong Kong and abroad; app-only broker	6.64 million brokerage accounts, 30 June 2026	3.84 million funded accounts	58	Positive balance, 30 June 2026
Webull. United States and abroad; commission-free app	28.2 million registered users, 30 June 2026	5.13 million funded accounts	18	Registered users need not open an account; 30 June 2026
eToro. Global; social trading app	About 38 million registered users	About 3.5 million funded accounts	about 9	Registered users; as reported in 2025

Source: DNSE Securities (2026d); TCBS (2026c); VNDIRECT Securities (2026); SSI Securities Corporation (2026); Robinhood Markets (2024); Futu Holdings (2026b); Webull Corporation (2026); Ho Chi Minh City Securities Corporation (2025) for eToro; authors' calculations. The TCBS figure is read from an unlabelled chart and is accurate to about 0.02 million; Ho Chi Minh City Securities Corporation (2025) separately reports about 30 per cent of TCBS accounts active regularly in the first quarter of 2025. VNDirect's figure adds three product tiers and may count a customer more than once. Measures differ in window and in base (accounts opened, funded customers or app registrations), so the table shows direction rather than exact gaps. No activity count was found for VPS, VPBankS, FPTs, HSC or Vietcap.

Appendix E. Customer review analysis

The tables below document the review cleaning, the cleaned Google Play sample, the theme coding and the cross-check against the App Store. Every count was recomputed from the cleaned files for this version and matches. Table E5 gives translated examples of the most-endorsed reviews.

Table E1. Review cleaning log

Stage	DNSE, Play	VPS, Play	FPTS, Play	DNSE, iOS	VPS, iOS	FPTS, iOS
Reviews retrieved	867	1,200	177	332	518	205
Loan advertising removed	127	23	0	0	0	0
Referral farming removed	70	3	0	73	6	0
Duplicates removed	0	3	0	0	0	0
Reviews retained	670	1,171	177	259	512	205
Mean rating before cleaning	3.29	2.60	2.18	3.37	1.57	2.31
Mean rating after cleaning	3.22	2.58	2.18	2.94	1.53	2.31

Source: Google Play and Apple App Store public listings; authors' cleaning code. VPS is its 1,200 most recent Google Play reviews, from 27 March 2023.

Table E2. DNSE Google Play reviews by year after cleaning

Year	Retrieved	Removed, %	Retained	Mean rating	One-word, %	Substantive mean	Four-word rule, %	Substantive mean, four-word rule
2020	3	0.0	3	3.67	0.0	3.67	33.3	3.00
2021	72	11.1	64	2.03	6.2	1.83	26.6	1.75
2022	207	46.4	111	3.18	18.0	2.85	34.2	2.49
2023	154	53.9	71	2.68	9.9	2.42	16.9	2.22
2024	202	4.5	193	4.35	33.7	4.15	62.7	3.74
2025	159	0.6	158	2.65	12.0	2.38	25.9	2.01
2026	70	0.0	70	3.06	12.9	2.85	25.7	2.48
All years	867	22.7	670	3.22	18.5	2.88		

Source: Google Play, retrieved 23 September 2026; authors' cleaning and coding. Substantive reviews exclude one-word reviews; the four-word rule is a sensitivity test.

Table E3. Themes in DNSE's negative Google Play reviews

Theme	Negative reviews	Share of negative reviews, %	Share of helpful votes, %	All retained reviews with theme
Crashes, freezes, login failures, slow orders	76	27.3	21.4	102
Account opening, identity checks, one-time passwords, chip reading	59	21.2	17.9	70
Explicit accusation of deception or fake reviews	49	17.6	28.2	52
Sign-up bonus terms, advertised rewards not received	24	8.6	17.8	34
Deposits not credited, withdrawal delays	14	5.0	6.7	24
Cannot close the account, closure fee	10	3.6	11.3	11
Interface, charts, layout	7	2.5	2.2	40
Arrived through a YouTube or social media referral	5	1.8	1.3	15
Charges different from the advertised rate	3	1.1	3.5	8
Any trust theme (deception, bonus terms, closure)	67	24.1	42.9	
Any product theme (stability, onboarding)	118	42.4	34.1	
Idle-cash product (Tài khoản không ngủ)	0	0.0	0.0	3

Source: as for Table E2. 278 one and two-star reviews carrying 1,794 helpful votes. Themes are not exclusive, so shares sum to more than 100.

Table E4. Three applications compared on both stores

Application	Google Play, retained reviews	Google Play, mean rating	Google Play mean, 2025 to 2026	App Store mean, 2025 to 2026	App Store one-star share, %	Apple rating, all ratings
DNSE Entrade X	670	3.22	2.77	2.25	59.0	4.04 (1,490 ratings)
VPS SmartOne	1,171	2.58	2.10	1.47	77.2	3.03 (5,756 ratings)
FPTS EzTrade	177	2.18	2.18	2.31	50.2	2.82 (76 ratings)

Source: Google Play (retrieved 23 September 2026) and Apple App Store (retrieved 24 September 2026); authors' cleaning. The store comparison covers 1 January 2025 to 21 September 2026.

Table E5. Selected DNSE reviews, translated from Vietnamese

Date	Stars	Helpful votes	Themes	Review
9 Jun 2025	1	58	Bonus, deception, closure	"Everyone, be careful, it is a scam. You do not receive the 100k. To delete your account you have to pay it 100k. It steals your information."
24 May 2025	1	54	Onboarding, closure	"I have been trapped. Anyone who wants to register should know that you cannot cancel the registration, even while the account is not yet approved ... after approval you have to go to the head office to delete the account."
28 Jun 2025	1	50	Bonus, deception	"Deceptive and false. There is no 100k straight away. You have to deposit at least 2 million to get it."
6 Aug 2025	1	32	Bonus	"False advertising. You have to deposit 2 million into the app to receive 100k, unlike the advertisement that says downloading the app earns 100k."
23 Sep 2021	1	28	Onboarding	"Registered at 10 am and waited until nearly 1 pm without getting in; it keeps saying to wait an hour for verification ... when money is involved and it is this slow, who would dare to use it?"
12 Jul 2025	1	25	Onboarding	"Why can it not scan the chip? Registering is so hard."
2 Jun 2025	2	18	Stability, money	"When I deposit outside trading hours, the money leaves my bank account but the securities account does not receive it. Customer service replies slowly."
23 Jan 2025	1	17	Bonus, fees, closure	"Closing the account costs a 100k fee. It is the first time I have heard of a securities company charging 100k to close an account. One star."
15 May 2026	5	13	Stability, idle cash	"Apart from occasional errors ... the DNSE app is the best securities app in Vietnam. Low fees. The idle account is the best. Watching the interest rise in real time is satisfying, and money earns interest automatically once it is deposited."

Source: Google Play, retrieved 23 September 2026. Translated by the authors; abbreviations expanded and ellipses mark omitted text.

Appendix F. Findex segment analysis

The segment analysis uses the published Findex aggregates for Vietnam, which report each indicator for twelve segments defined one dimension at a time. Table F1 defines the two indices, Table F2 reports the inputs and Table F3 the ranks under four weighting schemes. Figures F1 and F2 summarise the results used in Sections 3.2 and 3.4.

Table F1. Indicators in the two Findex indices

Index	Indicator code	Indicator
A, formally held surplus	fin17a	Saved at a bank or similar institution in the past year
A	fin17dm	Saved into an account every month
A	fin8	Stores money in an account
A	fin17e	Received interest on savings in the past year
A	fin17f	Saved for old age
A	fin24bd	Could cover expenses for more than two months without income
B, digital habit	dig.acc	Has a digitally enabled account
B	con26d	Uses the internet daily

Index	Indicator code	Indicator
B	con9a	Main phone is a smartphone
B	fin25e3w	Makes an in-store mobile or card payment every week
B	fin9b	Used a mobile phone or the internet to check an account balance
B	fin32.acc	Received wages into an account

Source: World Bank (2025b). Each index is the simple mean of its six indicators, in per cent of adults in the segment.

Table F2. Index segment indicators for Vietnam, 2024 fieldwork

Segment	Share of adults, %	Index A	Index B	Has an account, %	Saved at an institution, %	Gap, points	Unconverted adults, million	Wages into an account, %	Saves monthly into an account, %	Saved for old age, %
All adults	100.0	36.8	59.4	70.5	43.1	27.5	22.1	37.0	19.6	20.2
Women	51.2	38.6	59.0	69.9	45.1	24.8	10.2	34.8	22.4	23.4
Men	48.8	35.0	59.8	71.2	41.0	30.2	11.9	39.3	16.7	16.8
Aged 15 to 24	18.2	31.1	66.2	72.2	38.6	33.6	4.9	36.9	19.8	8.2
Aged 25 and over	81.8	38.1	57.9	70.2	44.1	26.1	17.2	37.0	19.6	22.8
Primary education or less	11.2	15.6	26.5	33.5	14.0	19.5	1.8	10.4	4.1	7.9
Secondary education or more	88.8	39.5	63.5	75.2	46.7	28.5	20.4	40.4	21.5	21.7
Poorest 40%	40.0	23.1	40.5	48.1	27.1	21.1	6.8	18.1	9.6	10.6
Richest 60%	60.0	46.0	72.0	85.5	53.8	31.7	15.3	49.5	26.4	26.5
Rural	67.0	33.8	56.1	67.4	40.5	26.9	14.5	33.5	16.8	18.0
Urban	33.0	43.0	66.0	77.0	48.4	28.6	7.6	44.1	25.4	24.6
Out of labour force	20.1	18.4	36.6	41.3	21.9	19.4	3.1	4.4	6.2	8.0
In labour force	79.9	41.5	65.1	77.9	48.4	29.5	19.0	45.2	23.0	23.2

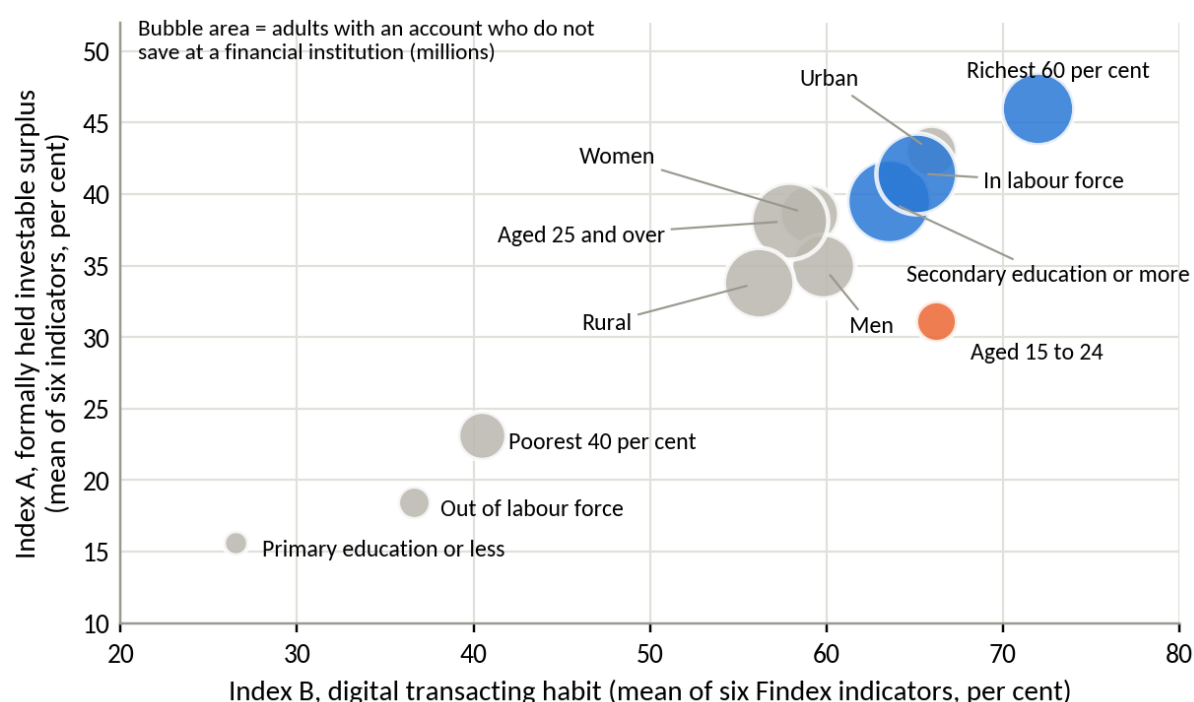
Source: World Bank (2025b); authors' indices. Index A averages six indicators of formally held surplus and Index B six indicators of digital habit (Table F1). The gap is account ownership minus saving at a financial institution. Unconverted adults hold an account but do not save at a financial institution.

Table F3. Segment ranks under four weighting schemes

Segment	Equal weights	Value-heavy	Scale-heavy	Reach-heavy	Score, equal weights
Richest 60%	1	1	1	1	0.933
In labour force	2	2	2	2	0.844
Secondary education or more	3	4	3	3	0.798
Urban	4	3	5	4	0.751
Aged 25 and over	5	5	4	6	0.710
Men	6	7	7	5	0.655
Women	7	6	8	8	0.636
Rural	8	8	6	9	0.609
Aged 15 to 24	9	9	9	7	0.549
Poorest 40%	10	10	10	10	0.233
Out of labour force	11	11	11	11	0.066
Primary education or less	12	12	12	12	0.024

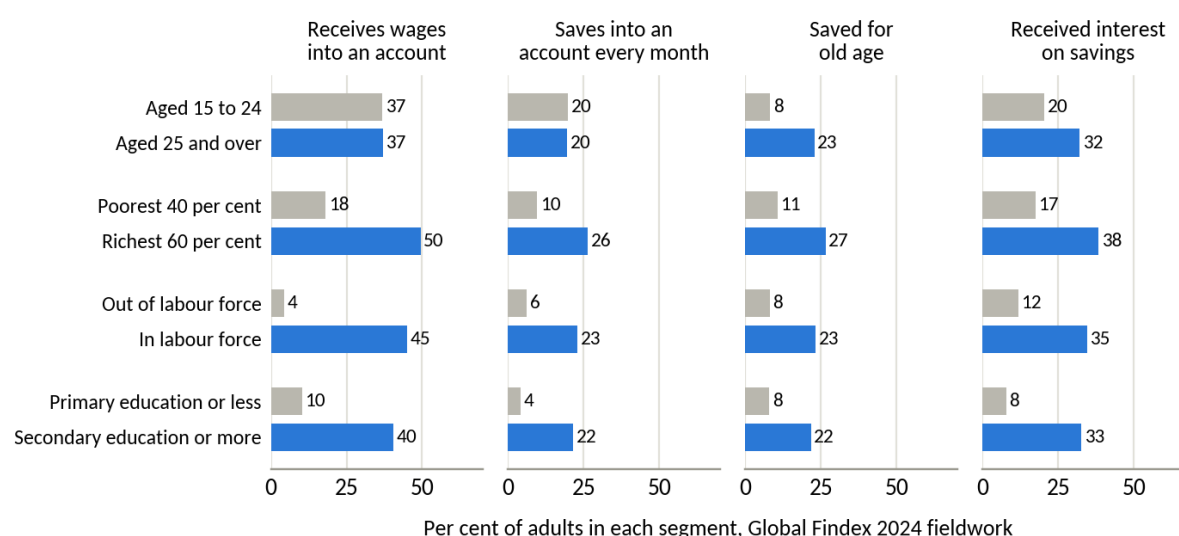
Source: authors' calculations from Table F2. Each criterion is min-max normalised across the twelve segments. Weights on (Index A, Index B, gap, unconverted adults, wage receipt, saving for old age): equal 1,1,1,1,1,1; value-heavy 3,1,1,1,2,2; scale-heavy 1,1,1,3,1,1; reach-heavy 1,3,2,1,1,1.

Figure F1. Vietnamese adult segments by digital habit and formally held investable surplus



Source: World Bank Global Index 2024 fieldwork; authors' indices. The two indices average different indicators, so segments are compared within each axis.

Figure F2. Payday and saving behaviour by segment pair



Source: World Bank Global Index 2024 fieldwork.

Appendix G. Methods, assumptions and limitations

Table G1 defines the calculated measures. Table G2 separates the assumptions behind the main results from the measured evidence, and Table G3 lists the limitations of the data together with the steps taken to contain them.

Table G1. Definitions of calculated measures

Measure	Definition
Share of a market	DNSE's value divided by the market total for the same measure and date, kept within its own market
Ratio to account share	Share of a market divided by DNSE's share of securities accounts (12.7 per cent)
Value per account	Balance or flow divided by the number of accounts at the same date
Core pre-tax profit	Pre-tax profit less gains, plus losses, on financial assets at fair value through profit or loss
Brokerage coverage	Brokerage revenue divided by direct brokerage and custody cost
Estimated cost of funds	Interest expense plus template line 24, less the rise in the allowance for loan losses, multiplied by four and divided by average borrowings and bonds
Yields	Quarterly interest income multiplied by four and divided by the average of opening and closing balances
Net interest margin	Interest on loans and on deposits and bonds held to maturity, less the estimated cost of funds, over average interest-earning assets, annualised
Industry totals	Reported as a range between a press tally of all brokers and the sum of the filed statements of the brokers in Vietcap's data service
Incremental cost decomposition	Change in each core cost line between two periods as a share of the change in core costs; core excludes gains and losses on financial assets at fair value
Profit gap	Additional loans equal the gap between the 2026 profit target and annualised core profit divided by the net lending spread; required customer assets equal required loans divided by the 2025 ratio of loans to customer assets
Scenario model	Assets per saver equal monthly contribution times retention times 18 months; revenue equals layer assets times the revenue yield
Findex indices and scores	Indices are means of six indicators; segment scores are weighted means of six criteria, each min-max normalised across the twelve segments
Helpful-vote share	Helpful votes on negative reviews carrying a theme divided by all helpful votes on negative reviews
Weighted prioritisation	Sum of weight times score across criteria, with an equal-weight total reported as a check

Source: authors.

Table G2. Register of assumptions behind the main results

Assumption	Value used	Type	Effect if wrong	How Round 3 tests it
DNSE accounts at mid-2026	1.7 million	Company-reported	Per-account values move in proportion; 0.1 million more accounts lowers cash per account by about 6 per cent	Internal account register
Market totals	Press tally (VND 86.6 trillion of investor cash, 453.8 trillion of lending, 15,200 billion of quarterly profit) and sum of filed statements (56.4 trillion, 345.3 trillion and 11,871 billion)	Measured and external estimate	DNSE's shares move between the two ends of each range; the conclusions hold at either end	Not needed
Cost of funds	Interest expense plus line 24 less the allowance rise	Derived	If line 24 contains more provisions than assumed, the cost of funds is overstated	Notes on borrowing costs
Net lending spread for the profit gap	4.88 points	Derived	A spread one point lower raises the required loans by about a quarter	Pricing and funding data
Scenario inputs	60,000 to 300,000 savers; VND 1.5 to 3.5 million a month; 60 to 80 per cent retained; revenue yield 0.5 to 1.0 per cent; 10 to 20 per cent of layer assets used as margin collateral	Assumption	Enrolment and contribution drive most of the variation	Payday pilot, yield test
Index segment sizes	Population shares from the survey	External estimate	Sampling error of a few points on each estimate	Microdata cross-tabulation
Review themes reflect customer concerns	Cleaned public reviews	Measured, self-selected	Levels overstate dissatisfaction; comparisons across apps and years are more reliable	Complaint logs and customer survey

Source: authors. Type distinguishes measured facts, derived calculations, external estimates and assumptions.

Table G3. Limitations of the evidence

Limitation	Effect on the findings	Mitigation
No customer-level data from DNSE	Funnel stages and funded-account rates are inferred	Several independent measures point the same way; internal data are the first Round 3 task
Account definitions differ, and one person can hold several accounts	Per-account comparisons are approximate	Comparison with named peers on the same basis; ratios are large enough to survive errors of 20 per cent
Dates differ across sources (peer account counts from September 2025 to May 2026; balances at 30 June 2026)	Small bias in shares	Dates stated in every note; the gaps are large enough to survive the date differences

Limitation	Effect on the findings	Mitigation
Template line 24 combines provisions with borrowing costs	The cost of funds is an estimate	Allowance changes deducted; the direction of change holds under either treatment
Industry totals differ between press tallies and the sum of filed statements	DNSE's shares vary by up to 1.2 points	Both totals reported as ranges
App store reviews are self-selected and contain spam	Levels are biased	One cleaning rule for three apps, helpful-vote weighting, App Store cross-check
Findex reports one dimension at a time from 1,000 interviews; the jump in formal saving between 2022 and 2024 may partly reflect survey changes	Segment intersections are unknown and the trend may be overstated	Ranks tested under four weightings; microdata analysis planned
Scores in the prioritisation and option matrices are judgements	Rankings could change with other weights	Explicit weights, equal-weight check, evidence cited for each score
Scenario figures are projections	They indicate scale and are not forecasts	Three scenarios and a validation plan with thresholds
Foreign models operate under different rules	Some lessons do not transfer	Transferability assessed design by design

Source: authors.

Appendix H. Data sources and access

Table H1. Data sources, access and dates

Dataset	Provider and access	Coverage and date
DNSE statements	Vietcap IQ data service (iq.vietcap.com.vn), line by line; DNSE investor relations (ir.dnse.com.vn) for the reviewed half-year statements	First quarter of 2018 to second quarter of 2026; retrieved 24 September 2026
DNSE company indicators and product terms	DNSE releases and product pages; financial press	2024 to September 2026; accessed 20 to 24 September 2026
Exchange and industry data	HOSE and HNX quarterly announcements read from the exchanges' own news services (139 HNX notices from the fourth quarter of 2017; HOSE from 2023); VSDC annual reports 2018 to 2025 and the vsd.vn account counter; filed statements of 42 securities firms through Vietcap; press tallies only for industry totals of investor cash, lending and profit	Second quarter of 2026; account data to August 2026
Google Play reviews	Public listings of vn.com.encapital.arrow, vn.com.vpbs.smartone and com.fpts.eztrade	Retrieved 23 September 2026; cut-off 21 September 2026
App Store reviews	Public review feeds of the same three applications	Retrieved 24 September 2026
World Bank Global Findex	World Bank Open Data interface (api.worldbank.org, source 28, Vietnam); microdata catalogue 7998 identified for Round 3	Waves 2011 to 2024; retrieved 20 September 2026
Macro, banking and payments	National Statistics Office releases (nso.gov.vn, also reported by Chinhphu.vn); State Bank of Vietnam data as reported by the press; FiinRatings; KPMG	2025 to September 2026
International comparators	Company results releases and regulators' publications	2021 to August 2026
Share price	Simplize market data	24 September 2026

Source: authors. Supporting files, including the consolidated data workbook (FBA_Round2_DNSE_data_pack.xlsx) and the Python and JavaScript scripts that collect, clean and chart the data, can be shared through the team's folder.

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